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METHODS FOR INCREASING THE NUMBER OF COUNTERMEASURE EXPENDABLES FOR DISPENSING SYSTEMS

Abstract

Various systems and methods for leveraging legacy countermeasure dispensing systems (CMDSSs). The legacy CMDSSs are leveraged through the expansion of breechplates and magazines in a CMDS by expanding the amount of expendables carried by a CMDS while still maintaining the legacy sequencer and dispenser in a legacy military platform, such as an aircraft. In addition, various circuitry systems are included in a circuit card of the breechplate for duplicating and/or expanding the firing lines provided in a legacy CMDS.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] This application is a divisional of and claims priority to U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/345,551, filed on Jun. 11, 2021, which is herein incorporated by reference in its entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

[0002] The present disclosure generally relates to aircraft defense systems. More particularly, the present disclosure relates to a Countermeasure Dispenser System (CMDS). Specifically, the present disclosure relates to a system and methods for firing expendables from a CMDS.

BACKGROUND

[0003] In current military technologies, military platforms, such as a military aircraft, include at least one CMDS. The CMDS dispenses expendables (i.e., chaff material or flares) from the platform in order to counter a detected incoming threat, such as a missile, and redirect such incoming threat away from the platform. In a conventional CMDS, such as the AN/ALE-47 CMDS used on an aircraft, a CMDS generally comprises a cockpit control unit that provides an interface with the operator of the military platform, sequencer units that control countermeasure dispensers, and a programmer that may provide additional features and characteristics for a CMDS. Each countermeasure dispenser in a CMDS is electrically connected to a sequencer unit for dispensing the expendables. However, the traditional countermeasure dispenser in a CMDS is limited to only carrying thirty (30) expendables with a corresponding sequencer having thirty (30) firing lines to dispense said expendables. Such limit of expendables and firing lines in the CMDS may cause issues during military operation when many expendables must be dispensed from the CMDS in critical situations. The countermeasure dispenser and the sequencer in a CMDS also limits the capability of expanding the amount of expendables that may be provided on a military platform without removing and replacing the existing countermeasure dispenser and sequencer unit.

SUMMARY

[0004] The current CMDS used on military platforms fails to provide a solution that expands the amount of expendables in a CMDS while still utilizing legacy hardware on said military platforms. As such, continuous unmet needs have been presented for expanding the amount of expendables in a CMDS while still utilizing legacy hardware on a military platform. The embodiments described and illustrated herein have provided solutions to the continuous unmet needs of expanding the amount of expendables on a CMDS while still utilizing legacy hardware on said military platforms. Aspects of the present disclosure are directed to these continuous unmet needs.

[0005] In one aspect, an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure may provide a countermeasure dispensing system (CMDS). The CMDS has a dispenser, a breechplate, a sequencer, and a magazine. The dispenser is provided on a platform. The dispenser has a first end that defines a first opening and a second end, and the first opening provides access to a chamber that extends from the first opening to the second end. The breechplate operably engaged with the dispenser, and the breechplate has first and second sets of firing pins electrically connected to a circuit card. The sequencer is electrically connected to the circuit card, the sequencer is adapted to control the first and second sets of firing pins via a set of firing lines. The magazine is operably engaged with the breechplate, the magazine has a set of passageways to hold a plurality of expendables that is electrically connected to the first and second sets of firing pins. The second set of firing pins is greater than the first set of firing pins.

[0006] In another aspect, an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure may provide that the

first set of firing pins has a single firing pin electrically connected to a first firing line in the set of firing lines. The second set of firing pins has a pair of firing pins electrically connected to a second firing line in the set of the firing lines.

[0007] In another aspect, an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure may provide that the first set of firing pins has a single firing pin that is electrically connected to a first firing line in the set of firing lines. The second set of firing pins has a pair of firing pins that is electrically connected to a second firing line in the set of the firing lines. In the exemplary embodiment, one of the firing pins of the pair of firing pins from the second set of firing lines is in series with a Zener diode.

[0008] In another aspect, an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure may provide that the first set of firing pins has a single firing pin electrically connected to a first firing line in the set of firing lines. The second set of firing pins has a pair of firing pins electrically connected to a second firing line in the set of the firing lines. In the exemplary embodiment, each firing pin of the pair of firing pins from the second set of firing lines is in series with a logic switch provided by a field programmable gate array (FPGA) that is embedded in the circuit card. The FPGA is operably controlled by the sequencer for controlling the states of the logic switches.

[0009] In another aspect, an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure may provide that the first set of firing pins has a single firing pin electrically connected to a first firing line in the set of firing lines. The second set of firing pins has a pair of firing pins electrically connected to a second firing line in the set of the firing lines. In the exemplary embodiment, a first firing pin of the pair of firing pins from the second set of firing lines is provided in a first bank of firing pins and a second firing pin of the pair of firing pins from the second set of firing lines is provided in a second bank of firing pins. The sequencer is adapted to select between the first bank of firing pins and the second bank of firing pins

[0010] In yet another aspect, an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure may provide a method. The method comprises the steps of providing a breechplate operably coupled to a dispenser disposed on a platform; providing a magazine for insertion into the dispenser, the magazine operably engaging the breechplate and housing a plurality of expendables; initiating a countermeasure dispensing system; determining the number of expendables from the plurality of expendables housed inside of the magazine; selecting at least one firing pin from a set of firing pins, wherein the at least one firing pin is one of a pair of firing pins electrically connected to a firing line in the set of firing lines; sending a first signal, by the sequencer, to the at least one firing pin in the pair of firing lines; and dispensing a first expendable from the magazine by the at least one firing pin in the pair of firing pins.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE SEVERAL VIEWS OF THE DRAWINGS

[0011] Sample embodiments of the present disclosure are set forth in the following description, are shown in the drawings and are particularly and distinctly pointed out and set forth in the appended claims.

[0012] FIG. 1 (FIG. 1) is a diagrammatic view showing an aircraft having a CMDS used upon detecting an incoming enemy threat.

[0013] FIG. 2 (FIG. 2) is a diagrammatic view showing the CMDS and the electrical system of the aircraft according to one embodiment.

[0014] FIG. 3A (FIG. 3A) is a top isometric perspective view of one example of the CMDS.

[0015] FIG. 3B (FIG. 3B) is a top exploded isometric perspective view of the example CMDS illustrated in FIG. 3A.

[0016] FIG. 4 (FIG. 4) is a top isometric perspective view of the breechplate assembly of the example CMDS illustrated in FIG. 3A.

[0017] FIG. 5 (FIG. 5) is a front end elevation view of the breechplate assembly of the example CMDS illustrated in FIG. 3A.

[0018] FIG. 6 (FIG. 6) is a left side cross-sectional view of the breechplate assembly of the CMDS illustrated in FIG. 3A taken along line 6-6 of FIG. 5.

[0019] FIG. 7 (FIG. 7) is a right side elevation view of the example CMDS illustrated in FIG. 3A taken along line 7-7 of FIG. 3A. The magazine is protruding from the dispenser in the example CMDS.

[0020] FIG. 8 (FIG. 8) is a left side cross-sectional view of the breechplate assembly, the magazine, and the plurality of expendables of the example CMDS illustrated in FIG. 3A.

[0021] FIG. 9 (FIG. 9) is an electrical circuit diagram of the circuit card of the breechplate assembly in the example CMDS illustrated in FIG. 3A.

[0022] FIG. 10 (FIG. 10) is an electrical circuit diagram of the circuit card of the breechplate assembly in another example of the CMDS.

[0023] FIG. 11 (FIG. 11) is a top exploded isometric perspective view of another example CMDS.

[0024] FIG. 12 (FIG. 12) is a right side elevation view of the example CMDS illustrated in FIG. 11 where the magazine is even with the dispenser in the example CMDS.

[0025] FIG. 13 (FIG. 13) is a top isometric perspective view of the breechplate assembly of the example CMDS illustrated in FIG. 12.

[0026] FIG. 14 (FIG. 14) is a front elevation view of the breechplate assembly of the example CMDS illustrated in FIG. 12.

[0027] FIG. 15 (FIG. 15) is a right side elevation cross-sectional view of the breechplate assembly of the example CMDS illustrated in FIG. 12 taken along line 15-15 of FIG. 14.

[0028] FIG. 16A (FIG. 16A) is a front elevation view of the magazine of the example CMDS illustrated in FIG. 12 where the magazine may be loaded with one type of expendable.

[0029] FIG. 16B (FIG. 16B) is a front elevation view of an alternative magazine of the magazine illustrated in FIG. 16A where the alternative magazine can be loaded with two different types of expendables.

[0030] FIG. 16C (FIG. 16C) is a front elevation view of an alternative magazine of the magazine illustrated in FIG. 16A where the alternative magazine can be loaded with three different types of expendables according to one embodiment.

[0031] FIG. 17 (FIG. 17) is an electrical circuit diagram of the circuit card of the breechplate assembly in another example CMDS.

[0032] FIG. 18 (FIG. 18) is a top isometric perspective view of another example CMDS.

[0033] FIG. 19 (FIG. 19) is a top exploded isometric perspective view of the example CMDS illustrated in FIG. 18.

[0034] FIG. 20 (FIG. 20) is a rear partial isometric perspective view of the magazine of the example CMDS illustrated in FIG. 18 where the plurality of expendables is loaded into the plurality of passageways provided in the magazine and where the retaining plate is covering the plurality of expendables once loaded in the magazine.

[0035] FIG. 21 (FIG. 21) is a top exploded isometric perspective view of another example CMDS.

[0036] FIG. 22A (FIG. 22A) is a top isometric perspective view of the magazine of the example CMDS illustrated in FIG. 21 where the magazine may be loaded with one type of expendable.

[0037] FIG. 22B (FIG. 22B) is a top isometric perspective view of an alternative magazine of the example CMDS illustrated in FIG. 21 where the alternative magazine can be loaded with three different types of expendables.

[0038] FIG. 23 (FIG. 23) is an electrical circuit diagram of the wiring harness of the CMDS between the sequencer and dispenser of the CMDS illustrated in FIG. 21.

[0039] FIG. 24 (FIG. 24) is an electrical circuit diagram of the circuit card of the breechplate assembly in another example CMDS.

[0040] FIG. 25 (FIG. 25) illustrates an exemplary method flow chart for dispensing expendables

from a CMDS.

[0041] Similar numbers refer to similar parts throughout the drawings.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0042] FIG. 1 illustrates a platform 1 such as a vehicle, ship or aircraft, which may be manned or unmanned, that includes a main body 2. As used herein, aircraft refers to fixed and rotary wing aircraft as well as UAVs and satellites. The main body 2 has a front end 2A and a rear end 2B that opposes the front end 2A. It should be understood that the directions of “front,” “rear,” “top,” “bottom,” “right,” and “left” are only used as a directional reference for the main body 2 and its associated components and/or parts described herein and illustrated in FIG. 1.

[0043] The platform 1 in this example is an aircraft and includes a sidewall 3 that extends from the front end 2A of the main body 2 to the rear end 2B of the main body 2. The sidewall 3 defines an opening 4 that is disposed between the front and rear ends 2A, 2B of the main body 2 that provides access to a chamber 5. The opening 4 and the chamber 5 defined by the sidewall 3 is sized and configured to receive a countermeasure dispensing system 6 (“CMDS”). The CMDS 6 operably engages the sidewall 3 of the main body 2 to mechanically fix the CMDS 6 to the aircraft 1. As illustrated in FIG. 1, the CMDS 6 is in line with the sidewall 3 of the main body 2 such that the CMDS 6 is even with the mold line of the aircraft 1 for aerodynamic purposes. In other embodiments, however, the CMDS 6 is uneven with the mold line of the aircraft 1, which are described in further details below. Upon mounting the CMDS 6, the CMDS 6 is electrically connected to a legacy wiring harness (not illustrated) that is provided in the aircraft 1 to provide power and communication to all electrical components in the CMDS 6, which is described in more detail below. As used herein, electrically connected or electrically coupled refers to a direct or indirect connection unless otherwise specified.

[0044] Prior to military operation or an aerial mission of the aircraft 1, the CMDS is pre-loaded with a plurality of expendables 7. Each expendable of the plurality of expendables 7 is loaded with flare and/or chaff material 8 for countermeasure purposes. In addition, each expendable of the plurality of expendables 7 includes an impulse cartridge (not illustrated) for detonating and dispensing the expendable from the aircraft 1. During military operation, the flare and/or chaff material 8 provides a distraction to an incoming enemy threat 9, initiated by an enemy “E”, where the incoming enemy threat 9 is diverted to the flare and/or chaff material 8 while allowing the aircraft 1 to remain unscathed. During military operation or an aerial mission, the aircraft 1 may receive a warning from an on-board electronic warfare (EW) system regarding the incoming enemy threat 9 approaching the aircraft 1. Upon a determination made by the on-board EW system and/or an operator, the CMDS 6 dispenses a calculated amount of expendables of the plurality of expendables 7 that are disposed underneath, behind, or to the side of the aircraft 1. In addition, the CMDS 6 may also be provided along any suitable location of the aircraft 1 other than sidewall 3 of the main body 2. In one exemplary embodiment, a CMDS may be provided within a wing of an aircraft. In another exemplary embodiment, a CMDS may be provided in a fuselage or a pod disposed on an aircraft. In another exemplary embodiment, a CMDS may be provided on a separate device operably engaging an aircraft (e.g., a towable device).

[0045] FIG. 2 illustrates one embodiment for a system 10 of the electrical connections between the legacy electrical components on the aircraft 1 with the CMDS 6. The system 10 includes an aircraft and/or cockpit interface 12 that is electrically connected to a programmer 14 via discrete signals 13A and serial buses 13B. Such discrete signals 13A included in this system 10A are ON/OFF signals such as aircraft identification wiring, weight-on-wheels signals, pilot activated manual dispense signal, threat warning and jammer dispense signals, and other suitable discrete signals where the voltage in such discrete signals is nominally about 28 VDC or in a range from about 8 VDC up to about 36 VDC. The discrete signals 13A and the serial buses 13B used in this embodiment may be of any suitable components for providing electrical connection and transferring communication between the aircraft and/or cockpit interface 12 and the programmer

14. In one exemplary embodiment, an avionics bus and an electronic warfare bus may be utilized for providing electrical connection and transference of communication between the aircraft and/or cockpit interface with a programmer. The serial buses **13B** used in the aircraft in one example meet the military standard MIL-STD-1553. In addition, the programmer **14** is powered via an on-board power supply “V.sub.in” located on the aircraft **1**.

[0046] The system **10** also includes a sequencer **16** that is electrically connected to the programmer **14**. The sequencer **16** (labeled as “Smart D2 SQCR” in FIG. 2) is electrically connected to the programmer **14** via a first data link **15** (a Sequencer Data Link or “SDL”). The first data link **15** allows for communication between the programmer **14** and the sequencer **16** during military operation of the aircraft **1**. During military operation, the sequencer **16** may receive passageway types and fire commands from the programmer **14** over the first data link **15** based on incoming threats detected near the aircraft **1**. In addition, the sequencer **16** is provided with logic power “VL” to allow the sequencer **16** to perform the necessary logic and/or commands received from the programmer **14**. The logic power “VL” also allows the sequencer **16** to perform other logic and/or commands with other components in the system **10**, which are described in more detail below. The logic power “VL” is also available when the aircraft **1** is grounded or in flight when the system **10** is turned on by the pilot of said aircraft **1**. Moreover, the sequencer **16** is electrically connected to a squib power source **18**, which is about +28 VDC. The squib power source **18** is electrically connected to and in series with a safing component **20**. The squib power source **18** may be enabled when the safing component **20** is enabled via a safety switch (e.g., a fuselage safety switch, a weight-on-wheels squib power interruption relay, and other electrical components of the like). The safing component **20** may interrupt or inhibit the dispensing of a plurality of expendables **7**, to safeguard against inadvertent dispensing while being operated on the ground.

[0047] The system **10** also includes a dispenser **22** that is electrically connected to the sequencer **16** via a second data link **21** (GEN-X Data Link or “GDL”). The second data link **21** provides power and allows for communication between the sequencer **16** and the dispenser **22** during military operation of the aircraft **1**, such as identifying the type of magazine located in the dispenser **22** (described in detail below), sending power impulses to the dispenser for firing and/or detonating expendables, and polling electrical components provided in the system **10** (described in detail below). Such communication between the sequencer **16** and the dispenser **22** is also sent to the programmer **14** via the first data link **15** for assessing the magazine type, monitoring the remaining number of expendables provided in the dispenser **22**, and any expendable misfires that occurred.

[0048] The system **10** in this example also includes a breechplate **24** and a magazine **26** that are electrically connected to one another and are electrically connected to the dispenser **22**. The dispenser **22** and the breechplate **24** are electrically connected such that the breechplate **24** is powered by the second data link **21** and is able to communicate with dispenser **22**. Such power and communication allows the breechplate **24** to initiate tasks and/or commands sent from the sequencer **16** via the second data link **21**. Such tasks and/or commands may be identifying the type of magazine **26** located in the dispenser **22**, sending power impulses to the dispenser for firing and/or detonating expendables, and polling electrical components provided in the breechplate **24** and/or the magazine **26**. As such, the breechplate **24** may output data and information to the sequencer **16**, which may then be output to the programmer **14** to allow the system **10** to monitor certain variables and parameters along specific components during operation of the aircraft **1**. Furthermore, the breechplate **24** and the magazine **26** are electrically connected to allow the breechplate **24** to fire specific expendables from the magazine **26**. Such firing capabilities by the breechplate **24** through the electrical circuitry of the breechplate **24** are described in more detail below.

[0049] The system **10** as illustrated in FIG. 2 will be referenced in each of the embodiments described below. It will be understood that the system **10** retains a majority of legacy electrical components such as the cockpit interface **12**, discrete component **13A**, serial buses **13B**,

programmer **14**, first data link **15**, and second data link **21**. In addition, it will be understood that the system **10** may retain other legacy components such as the sequencer **16** and the dispenser **22**. Moreover, it will be understood that the system **10** may include breechplates **24** and magazines **26** that are not legacy components provided in the aircraft **1**. In one illustrated embodiment, a breechplate and a magazine, which are not legacy equipment, may be included into legacy equipment, such as a dispenser, provided on the military platform in which the magazine **26** may protrude outside of the dispenser **22** once loaded (see FIG. **11** and the description below).

[0050] Referring to FIGS. **3A-9**, a CMDS **100** according to one embodiment is illustrated with its associated components. As best seen in FIG. **3B**, the CMDS **100** includes a dispenser **110**, a breechplate assembly **112**, a magazine **114**, a plurality of expendables **116**, and a sequencer **118** (see FIG. **9**). As illustrated in FIG. **3A**, the CMDS **100** includes a front end **100A**, a rear end **100B** that opposes the front end **100A**, a first side **100C**, a second side **100D** that opposes the first side **100C**, a top end **100E**, and a bottom end **100F** that opposes the top end **100E**. The front end **100A** of the CMDS **100** faces outwardly towards the right side of the main body **2** when the CMDS **100** is provided in the chamber **5** of the aircraft **1**. The CMDS **100** also defines a longitudinal axis “X” that extends from the front end **100A** to the rear end **100B**, a transverse axis “Y” that extends from the first side **100C** to the right side **100D**, and a vertical axis “Z” that extends from the top end **100E** to the bottom end **100F**.

[0051] As illustrated in FIG. **3B**, the dispenser **110** includes a top wall **120** that is disposed near the top end **100E** of the CMDS **100**, a bottom wall **122** that opposes the top wall **120** and is disposed near the bottom end **100F** of the CMDS **100**, a pair of side walls **124** that are parallel to one another and are disposed between the top and bottom walls **120**, **122**, and a rear wall **126** that is disposed at the rear end **100B** of the CMDS **100**. The top wall **120**, the bottom wall **122**, and the pair of side walls **124** collectively define a front opening **127** that is disposed at the front end **100A** of CMDS **100**. The top wall **120**, the bottom wall **122**, the pair of side walls **124**, and the rear wall **126** collectively define a chamber **129** that extends from the front opening **127** to the rear wall **126**. The chamber **129** is sized and configured to receive and house the breechplate assembly **112** and the magazine **114** upon assembly of the CMDS **100**.

[0052] The dispenser **110** also includes a flange **128** that is disposed on each of the top wall **120**, the bottom wall **122**, and the pair of side walls **124** at the front end **100A** of the CMDS **100**. The flange **128** defines a plurality of apertures **130** that extends entirely through the flange **128** along an axis that is parallel to the longitudinal axis “X” of the CMDS **100**. The flange **128** of the dispenser **110** provides the capability of securing the CMDS **100** to the aircraft **1** via a plurality of fasteners (not illustrated) passing through the plurality of apertures **130** and into the aircraft **1**. The aircraft **1** may have a recessed portion disposed about the perimeter of the opening **4** such that flange **128** is even with the mold line of the sidewall **3**.

[0053] Referring to FIG. **3B**, the dispenser **110** includes a set of standoffs **132** that are provided on the rear wall **126** of the dispenser **110**. The set of standoffs **132** laterally extends from the rear wall **126** and into the chamber **129**. The set of standoffs **132** provides attachment points for fasteners to attach the breechplate assembly **112** and the magazine **114** to the dispenser **110**. The dispenser **110** also includes a pair of pins **134** that are provided on the rear wall **126** of the dispenser **110**. The pair of pins **134** laterally extend from the rear wall **126** and into the chamber **129**. The pair of pins **134** provide mounting points for the breechplate assembly **112** for mounting the breechplate assembly **112** to the dispenser **110**. As such, the set of standoffs **132** and the pair of pins **134** allow the breechplate assembly **112** to be maintained in the chamber **129** of the dispenser **110**.

[0054] Still referring to FIG. **3B**, the dispenser **110** includes sockets **136** that are provided on the rear wall **126** of the dispenser **110** proximate to side wall **124** of the dispenser **110** and the second side **100D** of the CMDS **100**. The sockets **136** are electrically connected to a wiring harness **138** that includes a plug **140**. The wiring harness **138** and the plug **140** are adapted to electrically connect to the sequencer **118** that is disposed at a different location in the aircraft **1**. The sockets

136, the wiring harness **138**, and the plug **140** allows the breechplate assembly **112** to be powered and communicate with the sequencer **118**, which is described in more detail below. In the illustrated embodiment, the dispenser **110** is a legacy D-59 Dispenser in a legacy AN/ALE-47 CMDS, meaning that the sockets **136**, wiring harness **138**, and plug **140** of the dispenser **110** supports a total of thirty firing lines that may be utilized by the sequencer **118**. As such, the sockets **136**, the wiring harness **138**, and the plug **140** match the legacy A-Kit and B-Kit wiring harnesses in the legacy aircraft **1**.

[0055] Still referring to FIG. 3B, the breechplate assembly **112** includes a front plate **150** that has a base wall **152**. The front plate **150** also includes a lateral wall **154** that is disposed about the perimeter of the base wall **152**. The lateral wall **154** extends laterally away from the base wall **152** towards the rear end **100B** of the CMDS **100**. As illustrated in FIG. 6, the base wall **152** and the lateral wall **154** collectively define a central opening **153** proximate to the rear end **100B** of the CMDS **100**. The central opening **153** also provides access to a central space **155** that is collectively defined by the base wall **152** and the lateral wall **154**.

[0056] Referring to FIGS. 3B through 5, the base wall **152** of the front plate **150** defines a first plurality of holes **156**. Each hole of the first plurality of holes **156** extends entirely through the base wall **152** from the exterior surface **152A** to the interior surface **152B** such that the exterior surface **152A** and the interior surface **152B** are in communication at each hole of the first plurality of holes **156**. In addition, each firing pin of a plurality of firing pins **158** is press-fitted to a retainer of a plurality of retainers **160** such that a firing pin of the plurality of firing pins **158** is disposed inside of a retainer of the plurality of retainers **160**. As illustrated in FIGS. 6 and 8, each hole of the first plurality of holes **156** is sized and configured to receive a retainer from the plurality of retainers **160** that includes a firing pin inside of said retainer such that the base wall **152** secures the plurality of firing pins **158** and the plurality of retainers **160** to the front plate **150**. Each retainer of the plurality of retainers **160** is press-fitted into the base wall **152** through a hole of the first plurality of holes **156**.

[0057] While a firing pin of the plurality of firing pins **158** is press-fitted to a retainer of the plurality of retainers **160**, a firing pin may operably engage a retainer in any suitable arrangement. Examples of operably engaging a firing pin to a retainer include attaching, affixing, adhering, connecting, fastening, fixing, gluing, joining, linking, mounting, riveting, securing, screwing, welding, and other suitable examples of operably engaging a firing pin to a retainer. Furthermore, while a retainer of the plurality of retainers **160** is press-fitted into the base wall **152** through a hole of the first plurality of holes **156**, a retainer may operably engage a base wall via a hole in any suitable arrangement. Examples of operably engaging a retainer to a base wall via a hole include attaching, affixing, adhering, connecting, fastening, fixing, gluing, joining, linking, mounting, riveting, securing, screwing, welding, and other suitable examples of operably engaging a retainer to a base wall via a hole.

[0058] As illustrated in FIG. 6, each firing pin of the plurality of firing pins **158** includes a first end **158a** that faces the front end **100A** of the CMDS **100** and a second end **158b** that faces the rear end **100B** of the CMDS **100**. The first end **158a** of each firing pin of the plurality of firing pins **158** is disposed exterior to the central space **155** of the front plate **150** and is proximate to the exterior surface **152A**. The second end **158b** of each firing pin of the plurality of firing pins **158** is disposed inside of the central space **155** of the front plate **150** and is proximate to the interior surface **152B**. Each of the first and second ends **158a**, **158b** is disposed outside a retainer of the plurality of retainers **160** when a retainer of the plurality of retainers **160** possess a firing pin of the plurality of firing pins **158**.

[0059] Referring to FIGS. 3B through 5, the breechplate assembly **112** includes a plurality of ground springs **162** that operably engages the front plate **150**. Each ground spring of the plurality of ground springs **162** is disposed on the exterior surface **152A** of the base wall **152**. Each ground spring of the plurality of ground springs **162** is also biased towards the front end **100A** of the

CMDS **100** in which each ground spring of the plurality of ground springs **162** is arched-shaped. In the illustrated embodiment, each ground spring in the plurality of ground springs **162** is disposed between two firing pins of the plurality of firing pins **158**. As such, the plurality of ground springs **162** is half of the amount of plurality of firing pins **158** that is provided on the breechplate assembly **112**. Each ground spring of the plurality of ground springs **162** provides a ground connection when a ground spring of the plurality of ground springs **162** contacts an impulse cartridge of an expendable of the plurality of expendables **116**, which is described in more detail below. Furthermore, each ground spring of the plurality of ground springs **162** includes a notch at each terminal end. The notch at each terminal end of each ground spring of the plurality of ground springs **162** allows a firing pin of the plurality of firing pins **158** to pass through the notch and prevent any contact between the ground spring and the firing pin once a ground spring and a firing pin collectively contact an impulse cartridge of an expendable from the plurality of expendables **116**.

[0060] As illustrated in FIG. 5, each ground spring of the plurality of ground springs **162** is fastened to the front plate **150** via a fastener of a plurality of fasteners **163**. While each ground spring of the plurality of ground springs **162** is fastened to the front plate via a fastener of a plurality of fasteners **163**, a ground spring may operably engage a front plate in any suitable arrangement. Examples of operably engaging a ground spring to a front plate include attaching, affixing, adhering, connecting, fixing, gluing, joining, linking, mounting, riveting, securing, screwing, welding, and other suitable examples of operably engaging a ground spring to a front plate.

[0061] The breechplate assembly **112** also includes a first set of through holes **164** and a second set of through holes **165** (seen in FIGS. 4 and 5). Each hole of the first set of through holes **164** and each hole of the second set of through holes **165** extends entirely through each component in the breechplate assembly **112**. The first set of through holes **164** is sized and configured to receive the set of standoffs **132** of the dispenser **110** for securing the breechplate assembly **112** to the dispenser **110**. The second set of through holes **165** is sized and configured to receive the pair of pins **134** of the dispenser for mounting the breechplate assembly **112** to the dispenser **110**.

[0062] Referring to FIG. 6, the breechplate assembly **112** includes a circuit card **166**. The circuit card **166** is sized and configured to be received by the central space **155** of the front plate **150**. The circuit card **166** includes a firing pin connector **168** that electrically connects the circuit card **166** to each firing pin of the plurality of firing pins **158**. Such connection allows the breechplate assembly **112** to communicate with the sequencer **118** through a plurality of firing lines **157** for sending and receiving data during military operation, which is described in more detail below. As illustrated in FIG. 6, the firing pin connector **168** attaches to each firing pin of the plurality of firing pins **158** where the firing pin connector **168** is disposed between the first and second ends **158a**, **158b** of each firing pin of the plurality of firing pins **158** proximate to the second end **158b** of each firing pin of the plurality of firing pins **158**. As such, the second end **158b** of each firing pin of the plurality of firing pins **158** is disposed between the firing pin connector **168** and the circuit card **166**. In addition, the second end **158b** of each firing pin of the plurality of firing pins **158** and the circuit card **166** define a clearance “C” once the breechplate assembly **112** is assembled. The clearance “C” between the second end **158b** of each firing pin of the plurality of firing pins **158** and the circuit card **166** is considered advantageous at least because the clearance “C” provides shock isolation between the plurality of firing pins **158** and the circuit card **166** when pyrotechnic reaction forces occur during the firing and/or denotation of an impulse cartridge in an expendable of the plurality of expendables **116**. Such firing and/or denotation of an impulse cartridge in an expendable of the plurality of expendables **116** is explained in further detail below.

[0063] As illustrated in FIGS. 6 and 8, the circuit card **166** also includes socket connectors **170** for powering and controlling the electrical components embedded in the circuit card **166**. The socket connectors **170** is configured to electrically connect to the sockets **136** on the dispenser **110**. Such

electrical connection between the circuit card **166** and the dispenser **110** allows the breechplate assembly **112** to communicate with the sequencer **118** for sending and receiving data during military operation, which is described in more detail below.

[0064] The breechplate assembly **112** also includes a rear plate **172**. The rear plate **172** defines a slot **173** that is sized and configured to allow the socket connectors **170** of the circuit card **166** to pass through the rear plate **172** and electrically connect to the sockets **136** of the dispenser **110**. The rear plate **172** is sized and configured to operably engage the circuit card **166** such that the circuit card **166** is secured to the rear plate **172**. Having the circuit card **166** being secured to the rear plate **172** is considered advantageous at least because this arrangement mitigates the flex-induced failures caused during military operation when the front plate **150** flexes due to the dispensing of the plurality of expendables **116**. In addition, the arrangement of the circuit card **166** and the rear plate **172** allows for future expansion and/or alteration of the circuit card **166** for automated passageway identification, passageway logic programming, and sustainable passageway power. While the circuit plate **166** is secured to the rear plate **172**, a circuit card may operably engage to a rear plate in any suitable arrangement. Examples of operably engaging a circuit card to a rear plate include attaching, affixing, adhering, connecting, fastening, fixing, gluing, joining, linking, mounting, riveting, screwing, welding, and other suitable examples of operably engaging a circuit card to a rear plate.

[0065] Furthermore, the rear plate **172** is secured to the front plate **150** in which the circuit card **166** is disposed between the front plate **150** and the rear plate **172** to form the breechplate assembly **112**. While the rear plate **172** is secured to the front plate **150**, a rear plate may operably engage to a front plate in any suitable arrangement. Examples of operably engaging a rear plate to a front plate include attaching, affixing, adhering, connecting, fastening, fixing, gluing, joining, linking, mounting, riveting, securing, screwing, welding, and other suitable examples of operably engaging a rear plate to a front plate.

[0066] As illustrated in FIG. 3B, the magazine **114** includes a top wall **180** that is disposed near the top end **100E** of the CMDS **100**, a bottom wall **182** that opposes the top wall **180** and is disposed near the bottom end **100F** of the CMDS **100**, a pair of side walls **184** positioned parallel to one another and disposed between the top and bottom walls **180**, **182**, a rear wall **186** that is disposed at the rear end **100B** of the CMDS **100**, and a front wall **188** that is disposed directly opposite to the rear wall **186** at the front end **100A** of the CMDS **100**. The magazine **114** also includes a plurality of dividing walls **190** that collectively defines a first plurality of passageways **192** that extends from the front wall **188** to the rear wall **186**. The magazine **114** also defines a front set of apertures **192A** disposed proximate to the front end **100A** of the CMDS **100** and a rear set of apertures **192B** disposed proximate to the rear end **100B** of the CMDS **100**. Each passageway in the first plurality of passageways **192** has a front aperture from the front set of apertures **192A** and a rear aperture from the rear set of aperture **192B** to receive and house an expendable from the plurality of expendables **116**.

[0067] As illustrated in FIG. 3B, the first plurality of passageways **192** defined by the magazine **114** has a total of forty-eight square passageways that are sized and configured to be loaded with a plurality of expendables, such as plurality of expendables **116**, where each expendable has the dimension of 1×1×8.1 inches. While the magazine **114** includes a total of forty-eight passageways in the first plurality of passageways **192** with the dimensions of 1×1×8.1 inches, any suitable number of passageways may be included in a magazine with a dimension of 1×1×8 inches. Examples of suitable numbers of passageways provided in a magazine with a dimension of 1×1×8.1 inches includes at least 30 passageways, more than 30 passageways, between about 48 passageways up to about 60 passageways, about 54 passageways, about 60 passageways, and any other suitable numbers of passageways provided in a magazine with a dimension of 1×1×8.1 inches.

[0068] While the magazine **114** includes a first plurality of passageways **192** where each

passageway has the dimension of $1 \times 1 \times 8$ inches, a magazine may have any suitable size of passageway. Examples of suitable sizes of passageways that may be provided in a magazine include $1 \times 2 \times 8.1$ inches, $2 \times 2.5 \times 8.1$ inches, and any other suitable sizes of passageways that may be provided in a magazine. If the $1 \times 2 \times 8.1$ -inch passageway dimension is selected for a magazine, any suitable number of $1 \times 2 \times 8.1$ -inch passageways may be provided in the magazine. Examples of suitable numbers of $1 \times 2 \times 8.1$ -inch passageways that may be provided in a magazine include one, at least one, two, plurality, three, four, five, six, seven, eight, and any other suitable number of $1 \times 2 \times 8.1$ -inch passageway that may be provided in a magazine. If the $2 \times 2.5 \times 8.1$ -inch passageway dimension is selected for a magazine, any suitable number of $2 \times 2.5 \times 8.1$ -inch passageways may be provided in the magazine. Examples of suitable numbers of $2 \times 2.5 \times 8.1$ -inch passageways that may be provided in a magazine include one, at least one, two, plurality, three, four, five, six, and any other suitable number of $2 \times 2.5 \times 8.1$ -inch passageway that may be provided in a magazine.

[0069] Furthermore, the number of passageways **192** provided in a magazine **114** is complementary to the number of firing pins **158** provided in a breechplate assembly **112**. Such complementary configuration between the number of passageways **192** and the number of firing pins **158** is dependent upon the types of expendables being used in the magazine **114**. In one example, a number of passageways in a magazine and a number of firing pins in a breechplate assembly is 48 passageways and 48 firing pins when the dimension of the expendable is $1 \times 1 \times 8.1$ inches. In another example, a number of passageways in a magazine and a number of firing pins in a breechplate assembly is 54 passageways and 54 firing pins when the dimension of the expendable is $1 \times 1 \times 8.1$ inches. In another example, a number of passageways in a magazine and a number of firing pins in a breechplate assembly is 60 passageways and 60 firing pins when the dimension of the expendable is $1 \times 1 \times 8.1$ inches. In another example, a number of passageways in a magazine and a number of firing pins in a breechplate assembly is 14 passageways and 14 firing pins when the dimensions of the expendables are $1 \times 2 \times 8$ inches and $2 \times 2.5 \times 8$ inches. In another example, a number of passageways in a magazine and a number of firing pins in a breechplate assembly is 14 passageways and 14 firing pins when the dimensions of the expendables are $1 \times 2 \times 8$ inches and $2 \times 2.5 \times 8$ inches. It should be understood that none of the examples listed above shall limit number of passageways **192** provided in a magazine **114** that complement the number of firing pins **158** provided in a breechplate assembly **112**.

[0070] Referring to FIG. 3B, the magazine **114** defines a second plurality of passageways **194** that extends through the magazine **114** from the front wall **188** to the rear wall **186**. In the illustrated embodiment, the second plurality of passageways **194** are disposed parallel to the first plurality of passageways **192**. In addition, the second plurality of passageways **194** are positioned between the first plurality of passageways **192** proximate to the center of the front wall **188** of the magazine **114**.

[0071] In the illustrated embodiment, a portion of the magazine **114** protrudes beyond the flange **128** of the dispenser **110** at a first distance “D.sub.1” that is measured from the front surface of the front wall **188** to the front surface of the flange **128** (shown in FIG. 7). The magazine **114** protrudes due to the overall thickness of the breechplate assembly **112** in CMDS **100**. In the illustrated embodiment, the first distance “D.sub.1” is of about 0.51 inches from the front surface of the front wall **188** to the front surface of the flange **128**.

[0072] In the illustrated embodiment, the sequencer **118** in the CMDS **100** is a legacy ALE-47 Sequencer. The sequencer **118** retains its original hardware and wiring harnesses that electrically connect to the dispenser **110**. As such, the sequencer **118** only supports up to a total of thirty firing lines in the CMDS **100**. In addition, the sequencer **118** may receive updated logic and/or commands to allow the sequencer **118** to perform with the dispenser **110**, the breechplate assembly **112**, and the magazine **114**. In the illustrated embodiment, twelve of the thirty firing lines supported by the sequencer **118** and the dispenser **110** are electrically connected to a single firing pin in the plurality of firing pins **158**. In addition, eighteen of the thirty firing lines provided a pair of firing pins from

the plurality of firing pins **158** such that each firing line in the eighteen firing lines is electrically connected to first and second firing pins of a pair of firing pins from the plurality of firing pins **158**. Such expansion of firing pins is illustrated in FIG. 9, which is described in more detail below.

[0073] Prior to military operation, the magazine **114** will be loaded with a plurality of expendables **116**. The number of passageway in the first plurality of passageways **192** of the magazine **114** will limit the size and number of the expendables that may be loaded into the magazine **114** (e.g., every passageway in a plurality of passageways has the dimensions of 1×1×8 inches and a magazine includes a total of forty-eight passageways). Each expendable of the plurality of expendables **116** is loaded into the rear end of the magazine **114**. As such, an expendable of the plurality of expendables **116** is inserted through a rear aperture **192B** in a passageway of the first plurality of passageways **192** until the expendable reaches the first aperture **192A** at the front wall **188** of the magazine **114**. Once the plurality of expendables **116** is loaded into the magazine **114**, the fasteners **197** pass through the magazine **114** and the breechplate assembly **112** to operably engage the breechplate assembly **112** with the magazine **114** onto the dispenser **110**.

[0074] In the illustrated embodiment, the dispenser **110** in unmodified and is already provided on the aircraft **1**. As such, the installation of the dispenser **110** is not required in this embodiment. In addition, the wiring harness **138** is already electrically connected to the sequencer **118**.

[0075] The breechplate assembly **112** and the magazine **114** are then inserted through the front opening **127** and into the chamber **129** of the dispenser **110**. For mounting purposes, the pair of pins **134** are inserted the through holes **165** of the breechplate assembly **112** for mounting the breechplate assembly **112** to the dispenser **110**. Such mounting between the breechplate assembly **112** and the dispenser **110** helps align the set of standoffs **132** with the through holes **164** in the breechplate assembly **112** and with the fasteners **197** for ease of securing the breechplate assembly **112** and the magazine **114** to the dispenser **110**. Prior to securing the fasteners **197** to the set of standoffs **132**, the socket connectors **170** of the breechplate assembly **112** are electrically connected to the sockets **136** of the dispenser **110** to allow the communication between the breechplate assembly **112** and the sequencer **118** during military operation. Once the sockets **136** and socket connectors **170** are electrically connected, the fasteners **197** may then be secured to the set of standoffs **132** for securing the breechplate assembly **112** and the magazine **114** inside of the dispenser **110**.

[0076] As the breechplate assembly **112** and the magazine **114** are secured to the dispenser **110**, a firing pin of the plurality of firing pins **158** is disposed inside of an impulse cartridge of an expendable of the plurality of expendables **116** (as shown in FIG. 8). As such, each firing pin of the plurality of firing pins **158** is contacting the impulse cartridge of the expendable of the plurality of expendables **116** such that the firing pin may cause firing of the impulse cartridge and dispensing of the expendable. In addition, each ground spring of the plurality of ground springs **162** is contacting a pair of expendables of the plurality of expendables **116** for grounding purpose. Specifically, each ground spring of the plurality of ground springs **162** is in contact with a pair of impulse cartridges **117** that are provided in a pair of expendables of a plurality of expendables **116**. For example, a first end **162A** of a ground spring of a plurality of ground springs **162** contacts a first impulse cartridge **117A** of a first expendable **116A** of the plurality of expendables **116** to ground the first expendable, and a second end **162B** of a ground spring of the plurality of ground springs **162** contacts a second impulse cartridge **117B** of a second expendable **116B** of the plurality of expendables **116** to ground the second expendable.

[0077] As illustrated in FIG. 7, a portion of the magazine **114** protrudes outside of the dispenser **110** and into the exterior environment outside of the chamber **129**. Such protrusion of the magazine **114** is caused by the added thickness of the breechplate assembly **112** as compared to the legacy breechplate assembly provided in the legacy CMDS of the aircraft **1**. Traditional breechplate assemblies used in ALE-47 CMDS, however, are thinner to the allow magazine **114** to be even with the mold line of the sidewall **3**.

[0078] As illustrated in FIG. 9, the circuit card **166** includes the electrical circuitry that is able to leverage the sequencer **118**. The sequencer **118** is electrically connected to each and every firing pin of the plurality of firing pins **158** in two electrical configurations. In the first electrical configuration (not illustrated), the sequencer **118** is electrically connected to twelve of the thirty firing lines **157** where the sequencer **118** may operably control a single firing pin in the plurality of firing pins **158**. Here, the firing pins that are electrically connected to the twelve of the thirty firing lines **157** define a first set of firing lines. In this electrical configuration, each firing pin receives an electrical pulse sent by the sequencer **118** to dispense an expendable from a plurality of expendables **116**.

[0079] In the second configuration, eighteen of the thirty firing lines provides a pair of firing pins from the plurality of firing pins **158** such that each firing line in the eighteen firing lines is electrically connected to first and second firing pins of a pair of firing pins from the plurality of firing pins **158**. Here, the firing pins that are electrically connected to the eighteen of the thirty firing lines **157** define a second set of firing lines. As illustrated in FIG. 9, the sequencer **118** is electrically connected to a first pair of firing pins **158A**, **158B** in the plurality of firing pins **158** via a first firing wire **157A** in a plurality of firing wires **157**. The first firing wire **157A** splits off into first and second firing lines W.sub.1, W.sub.2. The first firing line W.sub.1 is electrically connected to the first firing pin **158A**, and the second firing line W.sub.2 is electrically connected to the second firing pin **158B**. In this illustrated embodiment, a Zener diode “D.sub.Z” is embedded in the second firing line W.sub.2 such that the sequencer **118** is in series with the Zener diode “D.sub.Z” and the second firing pin **158B**. The Zener diode “D.sub.Z” that is embedded in the second firing line W.sub.2 has a Zener voltage threshold “V.sub.Z” that must be overcome by a required voltage.

[0080] During operation of the electrical configuration, the sequencer **118** is able to send first and second pulses to the first and second firing pins **158A**, **158B** in order to fire first and second expendables **116A**, **116B** of the plurality of expendables **116**. To fire the first expendable **116A** in the plurality of expendables **116**, the sequencer **118** sends a first pulse to the first firing pin **158A** via the first firing line **157A**. The first pulse sent by the sequencer **118** includes a first voltage V.sub.1 that is less than the Zener voltage “V.sub.Z”, meaning the that first pulse is unable to pass the Zener diode “D.sub.Z.” As such, the first signal sent by the sequencer **118** will progress through the first firing line “W.sub.1” and towards the first firing pin **158A** to fire the first expendable **116A** of the plurality of expendables **116**. To fire the second expendable **116B** in the plurality of expendables, the sequencer **118** sends a second pulse to the second firing pin **158B** via the first firing line **157A**. The second pulse sent by the sequencer **118** includes a second voltage V.sub.2 that is greater than or equal to the Zener voltage “V.sub.Z”. As such, the second signal sent by the sequencer **118** will progress through the second firing line “W.sub.2”, past the Zener diode “D.sub.Z”, and towards the second firing pin **158B** to fire the second expendable **116B** of the plurality of expendables **116**.

[0081] The circuitry of the breechplate assembly **112** illustrated in FIG. 9 is considered advantageous to at least one exemplary embodiment because the inclusion of the Zener diode “D.sub.Z” into pairs of firing pins in the plurality of firing pins **158** allows the CMDS **100** to fire expendables of the plurality of expendables **116** independently. However, other mechanisms or instantiations of allowing the firing of the plurality of pins **158** through two independent lines are entirely possible. The independent firing of single expendables in the plurality of expendables **116** is accomplished by duplicating eighteen of the existing thirty firing lines, as provided on the dispenser **110**. In one exemplary embodiment, this is accomplished by embedding a Zener diode “D.sub.Z” into each expanded fire line so that each pair of firing pins may independently fire a single expendable rather than pair of expendables dependent upon the pulse voltage sent by the sequencer **118**. The existing eighteen firing lines in the illustrated embodiment are now expanded to thirty-six firing lines to provide a total of forty-eight firing lines in the CMDS **100** (i.e., eighteen of the thirty-six firing lines is embedded with a Zener diode “D.sub.Z”).

[0082] While the breechplate assembly **112** duplicates eighteen of the existing thirty firing lines that are provided on the dispenser **110** via the use Zener diodes, any suitable amount of existing firing lines provided on a dispenser may be expanded on a breechplate assembly. Example amounts of existing firing lines that may be expanded include a range between about **18** firing lines up to about **30** firing lines.

[0083] FIG. **10** illustrates another CMDS **200** that is similar to the CMDS illustrated in FIGS. **3A-9**, except as detailed below. In the illustrated embodiment, CMDS **200** includes substantially similar components of CMDS **100**. As such, the dispenser (not illustrated), breechplate assembly **212**, magazine (not illustrated), expendables (not illustrated), and sequencer **218** in CMDS **200** are substantially similar to the dispenser **110**, the breechplate assembly **112**, magazine **114**, expendables **116**, and sequencer **118**. As such, the dispenser and the sequencer are both legacy components provided in the aircraft **1**. However, the circuitry of the circuit card **266** in the breechplate assembly **212** is different than the circuitry of the circuit card **166** in the breechplate assembly **112**.

[0084] In the illustrated embodiment, the sequencer **218** includes a multiplexer (not illustrated). As illustrated in FIG. **10**, the multiplexer of the sequencer **218** is embedded into the circuitry of the circuit card **266** through the use of a field programmable gate array (FPGA) **267**. The multiplexer implements its associated control logic into the FPGA **267** to allow for the implementation of logic switches into the breechplate assembly **212**, which is described in more detail below. To include such control logic into the breechplate assembly **212**, the FPGA **267** includes additional electrical components such as a softcore processor, embedded memory (flash memory and RAM), universal asynchronous receiver/transmitter (UART), and programmable logic cells that allows for the duplication of the twenty-four fire selects from the existing thirty fire selects provided in the sequencer **218**. In the system, FPGA **267** is electrically connected to the sequencer **218** since the FPGA **267** is electrically connected to the multiplexer and is being powered by the sequencer **218**. The FPGA **267** is also electrically connected to ground. Additionally, the FPGA **267** is electrically connected to the sequencer **218** via the second data link **219** to allow communication and data sharing between the sequencer **218** and the FPGA **267**.

[0085] Similar to the circuitry of the circuit card **166** in the breechplate **112**, the circuitry of the circuit card **266** in the breechplate assembly **212** duplicates existing firing lines in the CMDS **200**. However, the circuitry of the circuit card **266** in the breechplate assembly **212** duplicates twenty-four (24) of the existing thirty firing lines provided in the dispenser **210** (an unmodified D-59 dispenser) and the sequencer **218** (unmodified ALE-47 sequencer). Such expansion of the firing lines distributes the firing lines across four legacy fire sources provided in the aircraft **1**. As such, circuit card **266** of the breechplate **212** expands the number of firing pins from thirty firing pins to fifty-four firing pins. With this expansion, the FPGA **267** provides the capabilities of using logic switches across each firing line provided in the expanded firing lines.

[0086] As such, twenty-four of the thirty firing lines provides a pair of firing pins from the plurality of firing pins **256** such that each firing line in the twenty-four firing lines is electrically connected to first and second firing pins of a pair of firing pins from the plurality of firing pins **256**. In the second configuration, which is illustrated in FIG. **10**, the sequencer **218** is electrically connected to a first pair of firing pins **256A**, **256B** in the plurality of firing pins **256** via a first firing line **255A**. The first firing line **255A** splits off into first and second firing lines W.sub.1, W.sub.2. The first firing line W.sub.1 is electrically connected to the first firing pin **256A**, and the second firing line W.sub.2 is electrically connected to the second firing pin **256B**. In this illustrated embodiment, the FPGA **267** embeds logic switches into first and second firing lines W.sub.1, W.sub.2. Still referring to FIG. **10**, a first logic switch "S.sub.1" is electrically connected to the FPGA **267** and is in series with the sequencer **218** and a first firing pin **256A**. In addition, a second logic switch "S.sub.2" is electrically connected to the FPGA **267** and is in series with the sequencer **218** and a second firing pin **256B**. Each of the first and second logic switches "S.sub.1", "S.sub.2" has an open state and a

closed state which are controlled via the FPGA 267 and the sequencer 218 during military operation. In the illustrated embodiment, each of the first and second logic switches “S.sub.1”, “S.sub.2” is in the open state. Such open and closed states between the first and second logic switches “S.sub.1”, “S.sub.2” allows for the individual firing of an expendable rather than a dual firing of two expendables.

[0087] During military operation and use of CMDS 200, the sequencer 218 selects the correct firing line from a plurality of firing lines 255 that is associated with the passageway required for polling, communication, and firing an expendable from the plurality of expendables. For the expanded firing lines that include pairs of firing pins, such as firing line 255A with first and second firing pins 256A, 256B in FIG. 10, the sequencer 218 will first communicate with the FPGA 267 via the second data link 219 to select which of the two firing pins prior to polling, communication, or firing. Once selection is completed, the sequencer 218 may send a first pulse to dispense a first expendable 216A of the plurality of expendables 216 from the CMDS 200. The first expendable 216A is electrically connected to the first firing pin 256A via an impulse cartridge provided in the first expendable. Upon detecting an enemy incoming threat via an on-board EW system, the sequencer 218 sends a first pulse over a first firing line 255A, which is electrically connected to the first and second firing wires W.sub.1, W.sub.2. Upon the sequencer 218 sending the first pulse, the FPGA 267 logically controls the states of the first and second logic switches “S.sub.1”, “S.sub.2” by having the first logic switch “S.sub.1” in a closed state and the second logic switch “S.sub.2” in an open state. The states of the first and second logic switches “S.sub.1”, “S.sub.2” forces the first pulse through the first logic switch “S.sub.1” and towards the first firing pin 256A to fire the first expendable 216. Such states of the first and second logic switches “S.sub.1”, “S.sub.2” is communicated by the sequencer 218 to the FPGA 267, via the second data link 219, for opening and closing logic switches embedded in the circuit card 266.

[0088] The sequencer 218 may also send a second pulse to fire a second expendable 216B of the plurality of expendables 216 from the CMDS 200. The second expendable is electrically connected to the second firing pin 256B. Upon detecting an enemy incoming threat via an on-board EW system, the sequencer 218 sends a second signal over the first firing line 255A, which is electrically connected to the first and second firing wire W.sub.1, W.sub.2. Upon the sequencer 218 sending the second pulse, the FPGA 267 logically controls the states of the first and second logic switches “S.sub.1”, “S.sub.2” by having the first logic switch “S.sub.1” in an open state and the second logic switch “S.sub.2” in a closed state. The states of the first and second logic switches “S.sub.1”, “S.sub.2” forces the second pulse through the second logic switch “S.sub.2” and towards the second firing pin 256B to fire the second expendable 216B. Such states of the first and second logic switches “S.sub.1”, “S.sub.2” is communicated by the sequencer 218 to the FPGA 267, via the second data link 219, for opening and closing logic switches embedded in the circuit card 266.

[0089] The inclusion of the FPGA 267 in the breechplate assembly 212 is considered advantageous at least because the FPGA 267 is able to communicate with the sequencer 218 for directing a specific pulse to specific firing pin for firing a specific expendable. On one hand, CMDS 200 may conserve and/or limit the amount of expendables dispensed from CMDS 200 due to the FPGA 267 being electrically connected to each firing pin in the expanded set of firing pins. On the other hand, the CMDS 200 may dispense a substantial amount of expendables based on the military operation. Such electrical connection between each firing pin in the expanded set of firing pins allows for the firing of a single expendable rather than a pair of expendables in the existing set of firing pins that are electrically connected to the FPGA 267.

[0090] FIGS. 11-15 illustrate another CMDS 300 that is similar to CMDS 100 illustrated in FIGS. 3A-9, except as described below. The CMDS 300 includes a dispenser 310, a breechplate assembly 312, a magazine 314, a plurality of expendables 316, and a sequencer 318. The dispenser 310 in the CMDS 300 is substantially similar to the dispenser 110 in the CMDS 100 due to the dispenser 310 being a legacy D-59 dispenser in an ALE-47 CMDS. The magazine 314 in the CMDS 300 is also

substantially similar to the magazine **114** in the CMDS **100**. The plurality of expendables **316** and the sequencer **318** are substantially similar to the plurality of expendables **116** and the sequencer **118** in the CMDS **100**. The breechplate assembly **312**, however, is different than the breechplate assembly **112** of CMDS **100**.

[0091] As illustrated in FIG. **11**, the CMDS **300** includes a front end **300A**, a rear end **300B** that opposes the front end **300A**, a first side **300C**, a second side **300D** that opposes the first side **300C**, a top end **300E**, and a bottom end **300F** that opposes the top end **300E**.

[0092] As illustrated in FIGS. **11** and **13-15**, the breechplate assembly **312** includes a front plate **350** that defines a first plurality of holes **354** that extends entirely through the front plate **350**. The first plurality of holes **354** are sized and configured to receive a plurality of firing pins **356** in which the plurality of firing pins **356** are press-fitted inside of the front plate **350** similar to the plurality of firing pins **356** disposed inside of the front plate **150** of the breechplate assembly **112**. While a firing pin of the plurality of firing pins **356** is press-fitted into the front wall **350** via a hole of the first plurality of holes **354**, a firing pin may operably engage a front plate inside of a hole in any suitable arrangement. Examples of operably engaging a firing pin to a front plate inside of a hole include attaching, affixing, adhering, connecting, fastening, fixing, gluing, joining, linking, mounting, riveting, securing, screwing, welding, and other suitable examples of operably engaging a firing pin to a front plate inside of a hole.

[0093] FIGS. **13** through **15** illustrate a set of gaskets **358** are provided on a select number of firing pins in the plurality of firing pins **356**. Each gasket of the set of gaskets **358** is provided on the front surface **350A** of the front plate **350**. In the illustrated embodiment, a total of four firing pins from the plurality of firing pins **356** are provided with gaskets of the set of gaskets **358**. Any suitable number of gaskets from a set of gaskets may be provided on a selected number of firing pins in a plurality of firing pins based on various considerations, including the types of expendables being used in the CMDS. Example numbers of gaskets that may be provided on a plurality of firing pins include one, at least one, two, a plurality, three, four, five, six, and any other suitable number of gaskets that may be provided on a select amount of firing pins of a plurality of firing pins. In addition, each gasket in the set of gaskets **358** includes two additional firing pins **360** to provide support to the companion smart stores communications interface (CSSCI) as well as smart stores communications interface (SSCI) on the aircraft **1**.

[0094] Still referring to FIGS. **13** through **15**, the breechplate assembly **312** includes a plurality of ground springs **362** that operably engages the front plate **350**. Each ground spring of the plurality of ground springs **362** is disposed on the front surface **350A**. Each ground spring of the plurality of ground springs **362** is also biased towards the front end **300A** of the CMDS **300** in which each ground spring of the plurality of ground springs **362** is arched-shaped. In the illustrated embodiment, each ground spring in the plurality of ground springs **362** is disposed between two firing pins of the plurality of firing pins **356**. As such, the plurality of ground springs **362** is half of the amount of plurality of firing pins that is provided in the breechplate assembly **312**. Each ground spring of the plurality of ground springs **362** provides a ground connection when a ground spring of the plurality of ground springs **362** contacts an impulse cartridge of an expendable of the plurality of expendables **316**. Furthermore, each ground spring of the plurality of ground springs **362** includes a notch at each terminal end. The notch at each terminal end of a ground spring of the plurality of ground springs **362** allows a firing pin of the plurality of firing pins **356** to pass through the notch and prevent any contact between the ground spring and the firing pin once a ground spring and a firing pin collectively contact an impulse cartridge of an expendable from the plurality of expendables **316**.

[0095] In addition, each ground spring of the plurality of ground springs **362** is fastened to the front plate **350** via a fastener of a plurality of fasteners **363**. While each ground spring of the plurality of ground springs **362** is fastened to the front plate via a fastener of a plurality of fasteners **363**, a ground spring may operably engage a front plate in any suitable arrangement. Examples of

operably engaging a ground spring to a front plate include attaching, affixing, adhering, connecting, fixing, gluing, joining, linking, mounting, riveting, securing, screwing, welding, and other suitable examples of operably engaging a ground spring to a front plate.

[0096] The breechplate assembly **312** also includes a first set of through holes **364** and a second set of through holes **365** (seen in FIGS. **13** and **14**). Each hole of the first set of through holes **364** and each hole of the second set of through holes **365** extends entirely through each component in the breechplate assembly **312**. The first set of through holes **364** is sized and configured to receive a set of standoffs (not illustrated) of the dispenser **310** for securing the breechplate assembly **312** and magazine **314** to the dispenser **310** via fasteners. The second set of through holes **365** is sized and configured to receive a pair of pins (not illustrated) of the dispenser **310** for mounting the breechplate assembly **312** to the dispenser **310**.

[0097] Referring to FIG. **15**, the breechplate assembly **312** includes a circuit card **366**. The circuit card **366** is similar to the circuit card **166** in the CMDS **100**. As such, the circuit card **366** electrically connects to each firing pin of the plurality of firing pins **356** substantially similar to how the circuit card **166** electrically connects to each firing pin of the plurality of firing pins **158** in CMDS **100**. However, a clearance between the plurality of firing pins **356** and the circuit card **366** is omitted from this embodiment due to the front plate **350** directly abutting the circuit card **366**. To prevent shock and damage issues between the front plate **350** and the circuit card **366**, the front plate **350** is made a robust material. Such robust material of the front plate **350** prevents shock and damages issues when pyrotechnic reaction forces occur during the firing and/or denotation of an expendable in the plurality of expendables **316**. In addition, the robust material of the front plate **350** may improve durability and prevent issues of a magazine cracking, such as magazine **314**, during handling. In the illustrated embodiment, the front plate **350** is made of a composite material for preventing shock and damage issues to the electrical circuitry provided in the breechplate assembly **312**. In one exemplary embodiment, a breechplate assembly may be formed from a metal material, more particularly aluminum or titanium. In another exemplary embodiment, a breechplate assembly may be formed from a composite material, more particularly a fiber-reinforced plastic material using glass fiber. In yet another exemplary embodiment, a breechplate assembly may be formed from a polymer material, more particularly carbon fiber material. In yet another exemplary embodiment, a breechplate assembly may be formed from a combination of materials described and illustrated herein and other suitable and/or similar materials described and illustrated herein.

[0098] Referring to FIGS. **13** and **15**, the breechplate assembly **312** also includes a rear plate **372** that is similar to the rear plate **172** of the breechplate assembly **112**. The rear plate **372** is secured to the front plate **350** in which the circuit card **366** is disposed between the front plate **350** and the rear plate **372** to form the breechplate assembly **312**. While the rear plate **372** is secured to the front plate **350**, a rear plate may operably engage to a front plate in any suitable arrangement. Examples of operably engaging a rear plate to a front plate include attaching, affixing, adhering, connecting, fastening, fixing, gluing, joining, linking, mounting, riveting, securing, screwing, welding, and other suitable examples of operably engaging a rear plate to a front plate.

[0099] In addition, the circuitry system of the circuit card **366** may use any circuitry system that is described and illustrated herein. The circuitry systems that may be used in the circuit card **366** includes the circuit system used in the circuit card **166** of CMDS **100**, the circuitry system used in the circuit card **266** of CMDS **200**, and other suitable circuitry systems in a circuit card that are described and illustrated herein.

[0100] As illustrated in FIG. **12**, a muzzle plate **396** operably engages the front end of the magazine **314** proximate to the front end **300A** of CMDS **300**. Here, the muzzle plate **396** is attached to the magazine **314** via fasteners **397**. The muzzle plate **396** is even with a flange **328** of the dispenser **310** and even with the side wall **5** of the aircraft **1** due to the overall width of the breechplate assembly **312**. While the muzzle plate **396** is secured to the magazine **314**, a muzzle plate may operably engage to a magazine in any suitable arrangement. Examples of operably engaging a

muzzle plate to a magazine include attaching, affixing, adhering, connecting, fastening, fixing, gluing, joining, linking, mounting, riveting, screwing, welding, and other suitable examples of operably engaging a muzzle plate to a magazine.

[0101] Referring to FIG. 16A, the magazine 314 defines a plurality of passageways 392. In this configuration, the magazine 314 may hold one type of expendable from the plurality of expendables as defined by the plurality of passageways 392. In the illustrated embodiment, the magazine 314 may hold an expendable with the dimensions of 1×1×8.1 inches as defined by the plurality of passageways 392. In other exemplary embodiments as illustrated in FIGS. 16B and 16C, a magazine may hold more than one type of expendable where the magazine is sized and configured to be disposed inside of the dispenser 310 and is complementary to the breechplate 312. As illustrated in FIG. 16B, an alternative magazine 314' may define a first plurality of passageways 392A' and a second plurality of passageways 392B' where the first plurality of passageways 392A' holds a first plurality of expendables and the second plurality of passageways 392B' holds a second plurality of expendables where the first and second pluralities of expendables may be of different dimensions. As such, each expendable housed inside of each passageway in the first plurality of passageways 392A' may have the dimensions of 1×1×8.1 inches, and each expendable housed inside of each passageway in the second plurality of passageways 392B' may have the dimensions of 1×2×8.1 inches. As illustrated in FIG. 16C, another alternative magazine 314'' may define a first plurality of passageways 392A'', a second plurality of passageways 392B'', and a third plurality of passageways 392C'' where the first, second, and third pluralities of passageways 392A'', 392B'', 392C'' may be of different dimensions. As such, each expendable housed inside of each passageway of the first plurality of passageways 392A'' may have the dimensions of 1×1×8.1 inches, each expendable housed inside of each passageway of the second plurality of passageways 392B'' may have the dimensions of 1×2×8.1 inches, and each expendable housed inside of each passageway of the third plurality of passageways 392C'' may have the dimensions of 2×2.5×8.1 inches.

[0102] FIG. 17 illustrates another CMDS 400 that is similar to the CMDS 300 illustrated in FIGS. 11-15, except as detailed below. The CMDS 400 includes a dispenser (not illustrated), a breechplate assembly 412, a magazine (not illustrated), a plurality of expendables 416, and sequencer 418. In the illustrated embodiment, the circuitry of a circuit card 466 in the breechplate assembly 412 is different than the circuitry of the circuit card 366 in the breechplate assembly 312.

[0103] The circuit card 466 of the breechplate assembly 412 includes a plurality of firing lines 457. Similar to the circuit cards 166, 266, and 366 of CMDSs 100, 200, 300, the circuit card 466 duplicates the legacy firing pins in a legacy D-59 dispenser from thirty (30) firing pins to at least forty-eight (48) firing pins (i.e., eighteen (18) of the existing thirty (30) firing lines have a pair of firing pins). FIG. 17 provides an example of a first firing line 457A being electrically connected to first and second firing pins 458A, 458B.

[0104] As illustrated in FIG. 17, the circuit card 466 of the breechplate assembly 412 is electrically connected to the sequencer 418 for providing power and communication to the breechplate assembly 412. In the illustrated embodiment, the second data link 422 electrically connects the sequencer 418 to the breechplate assembly 412. In addition, the first firing line 457A is also electrically connected to the sequencer 418. Once the sequencer 418 is electrically connected to the breechplate assembly 412, the sequencer 418 is electrically connected to a first resistor R.sub.1 such that the sequencer 418 is in series with a first resistor R.sub.1 via a first wire W.sub.1. The first resistor R.sub.2 is also electrically connected to the gate terminal of a first field effect transistor (FET) Q.sub.1 such that the first resistor R.sub.2 is also in series with a first FET Q.sub.1 via a second wire W.sub.2. The drain terminal of the first FET Q.sub.1 is electrically connected to a second resistor R.sub.2 such that the first FET Q.sub.1 is in series with the second resistor R.sub.2 via a third wire W.sub.3. The source terminal of the first FET Q.sub.1 is electrically connected to the ground terminal "GND" via a fourth wire W.sub.4. The drain terminal of the first FET Q.sub.1

is also electrically connected to the gate terminal of a second FET Q.sub.2 via W.sub.5. In addition, the second resistor R.sub.2 is electrically connected to the gate and drain terminals of the second FET Q.sub.2 such that the second resistor R.sub.2 is in parallel with the second FET Q.sub.2 via the third wire W.sub.3, the fifth wire W.sub.5, a sixth wire W.sub.6, and a seventh wire W.sub.7. The source terminal of the second FET Q.sub.2 is electrically connected to the first firing pin **458A** such the second FET Q.sub.2 is in series with the first firing pin **458A** via an eighth wire W.sub.8. In addition, the first firing line **457A** is electrically connected to the second resistor R.sub.2 and the drain terminal of the second FET Q.sub.2 via a ninth wire W.sub.9.

[0105] Moreover, the sequencer **418** is also electrically connected to a third resistor R.sub.3 such that the sequencer **418** is in series with the third resistor R.sub.3 via a tenth wire W.sub.10. The third resistor R.sub.3 is electrically connected to the gate terminal of a third FET Q.sub.3 such that the third resistor R.sub.3 is in series with the third FET Q.sub.3 via an eleventh wire W.sub.11. The drain terminal of the third FET Q.sub.3 is electrically connected to the fourth resistor R.sub.4 such that the third FET Q.sub.3 is in series with the fourth resistor R.sub.4 via a twelfth wire W.sub.12. The fourth resistor R.sub.4 is electrically connected to the output of the first firing line **457A** such that the fourth resistor R.sub.4 is in series with the first firing line **457A** via a thirteenth wire W.sub.13. The source terminal of the third FET Q.sub.3 is electrically connected to a gate terminal of a fourth FET Q.sub.4 such that the third FET Q.sub.3 is in series with the fourth FET Q.sub.4 via a fourteenth wire W.sub.14. The fifth resistor R.sub.5 is electrically connected to the ground terminal "GND" via a fifteenth wire W.sub.15. The first firing line **457A** is also electrically connected to the drain terminal of the fourth FET Q.sub.4 such that the first firing line **457A** is in series with the fourth FET Q.sub.4 via a sixteenth wire W.sub.16. The source terminal of the fourth FET Q.sub.4 is electrically connected to the second firing pin **458B** such that the fourth FET Q.sub.4 is in series with the second firing pin **458B** via a seventeenth wire W.sub.17.

[0106] In the illustrated embodiment, the sequencer **418** is electrically connected to each and every firing pin of the plurality of firing pins **458** in two electrical configurations. In the first electrical configuration (not illustrated), the sequencer **418** is electrically connected to twelve of the thirty firing lines where the sequencer **418** may operably control a single firing pin in the plurality of firing pins **458**. In this electrical configuration, each firing pin receives an electrical pulse sent by the sequencer **418** to dispense an expendable from a plurality of expendables **416**. In addition, eighteen of the thirty firing lines provides a pair of firing pins from the plurality of firing pins **458** such that each firing line in the eighteen firing lines is electrically connected to first and second firing pins of a pair of firing pins from the plurality of firing pins **458**. In the second configuration, which is illustrated in FIG. 17, the sequencer **418** is electrically connected to a first pair of firing pins **458A**, **458B** in the plurality of firing pins **458** via a first firing wire **457A**. The first firing pin **458A** of the pair of firing pins is embedded in a first bank of firing pins in the breechplate assembly **412**, and the second firing pin **458B** of the pair of firing pins is embedded in second bank of firing pins in the breechplate assembly **412**.

[0107] In the illustrated embodiment, the sequencer **418** is able to switch from the first bank of firing pins in the breechplate assembly **412** to the second bank of firing pins in the breechplate assembly **412** based on initiating the second data link **422**. In one exemplary embodiment, the sequencer **418** may disable power via the second data link **422** and poll the first bank of firing pins (i.e., poll the first firing pin **458A**). Once polling is complete, the sequencer **418** may send pulses to the first bank of firing pins until the expendables that are electrically connected to the first bank of firing pins have been dispensed from CMDS **400**. In another exemplary embodiment, the sequencer **418** may enable power via the second data link **422** and poll the second bank of firing pins (i.e., poll the second firing pin **458B**). Once polling is complete, the sequencer **418** may send pulses to the second bank of firing pins until the expendable that are electrically connected to the second bank of firing pins have been dispensed from CMDS **400**. Furthermore, the breechplate assembly **412** and the dispenser **410** are electrically connected to an additional logic power source and return.

These electrical connections provide an “always on” power to the legacy firing lines so that power is available when the second data link **422** is turned to the OFF state. The states of the second data link **422** is described in more detail below. Additionally, a feedback mechanism (not illustrated) would be electrically connected to the sequencer **418** to ensure the selection of the requested firing pin between the first bank of firing pins and the second bank of firing pins.

[0108] During military operation of the aircraft **1**, CMDS **400** is initiated once an enemy incoming threat is detected by the on-board EW system. In the illustrated embodiment, the sequencer **418** may disable power to the breechplate assembly **412** over the second data link **422** for polling the first bank of firing pins with their associated electrical components before dispensing the expendables electrically connected to the first bank of firing lines. In the illustrated embodiment, the sequencer **418** would poll the first bank of firing lines, which includes the first firing pin **458A**, through the first firing line **457A**. The polling performed by the sequencer **418** checks for readiness and/or the state of each firing pin the first set of firing pins, including the first firing pin **458A**. Once polling is complete and the first bank of firing pins is ready and/or in the correct state, the sequencer **418** may send a first pulse to a dispense the expendables electrically connected to the first bank of firing pins, which includes the first firing pins **458A**.

[0109] If the first bank of firing pins dispenses each and every expendable electrically connected to the first bank of firing pins, the sequencer may switch from the first bank of firing pins to the second bank of firing pins, which includes the second firing pin **458B** in FIG. **11**. In the illustrated embodiment, the sequencer **418** may enable power to the breechplate assembly **412** over the second data link **422** for polling the second bank of firing pins with their associated electrical components before dispensing the expendables electrically connected to the second bank of firing lines. In the illustrated embodiment, the sequencer **418** would poll the second bank of firing lines, which includes the second firing pin **458B**, through the first firing line **457A**. The polling performed by the sequencer **418** checks for readiness and/or the state of each firing pin the second set of firing pins, including the second firing pin **458B**. Once polling is complete and the second bank of firing pins is ready and/or in the correct state, the sequencer **418** may send a second pulse to a dispense the expendables electrically connected to the second bank of firing pins, which includes the second firing pins **458B**.

[0110] While FIG. **17** illustrates a single firing line (first firing line **457A**) electrically connected to a pair of firing pins (first and second firing pins **458A**, **458B**), such electrical circuitry illustrated and described herein is repeated for the remaining firing lines and firing pins in the circuit card **466**.

[0111] FIGS. **18-20** illustrates another CMDS **500** that is similar to the CMDS **100** illustrated in FIGS. **3A-9**, except as detailed below. The CMDS **500** includes a dispenser **510**, a breechplate assembly **512**, a magazine **514**, a plurality of expendables **516**, and a sequencer (not illustrated). In the illustrated embodiment, the plurality of expendables **516** and the sequencer are legacy CMDS components. As illustrated in FIG. **18**, the CMDS **500** includes a front end **500A**, a rear end **500B** that opposes the front end **500A**, a first side **500C**, a second side **500D** that opposes the first side **500C**, a top end **500E**, and a bottom end **500F** that opposes the top end **500E**. The CMDS **500** also defines a longitudinal axis “X” that extends from the front end **500A** to the rear end **500B**, a transverse axis “Y” that extends from the first side **500C** to the right side **500D**, and a vertical axis “Z” that extends from the top end **500E** to the bottom end **500F**.

[0112] As illustrated in FIG. **19**, the dispenser **510** includes a top wall **520** that is disposed near the top end **500E** of the CMDS **500**, a bottom wall **522** that opposes the top wall **520** and is disposed near the bottom end **500F** of the CMDS **500**, a pair of side walls **524** disposed parallel to one another and disposed between the top and bottom walls **520**, **522**. The top wall **520**, the bottom wall **522**, and the pair of side walls **524** collectively define a front opening **525** that is disposed at the front end **500A** of CMDS **500**. The top wall **520**, the bottom wall **522**, and the pair of side walls **524** also collectively define a rear opening **527** that is disposed at the rear end **500B** of the CMDS

500 opposite to the front opening **525**. The top wall **520**, the rear wall **522**, and the pair of side walls **524** also collectively define a central passageway **529** that extends along the longitudinal axis “X” from the front opening **525** to the rear opening **527**. The central passageway **529** is sized and configured to receive and house the breechplate assembly **512** and the magazine **514** upon assembly of the CMDS **500**.

[0113] The dispenser **510** also includes a flange **528** that is disposed on each of the top wall **520**, the bottom wall **522**, and the pair of side walls **524** at the front end **500A** of the CMDS **500**. The flange **528** defines a first plurality of apertures **530** that extends entirely through the flange **528** along an axis that is parallel to the longitudinal axis “X” of the CMDS **500**. The flange **528** of the dispenser **510** provides the capability of securing the CMDS **500** to the aircraft **1** via a plurality of fasteners (not illustrated) passing through the plurality of apertures **530** and into the aircraft **1**. The aircraft **1** may have a recessed portion disposed around the perimeter of the opening **4** such that flange **528** is even with the mold line of the sidewall **3** of the aircraft **1**.

[0114] The dispenser **510** also defines a second plurality of apertures **532**. The second plurality of apertures **532** is disposed on each of the top wall **520**, the bottom wall **522**, and the pair of side walls **524** at the rear end **500B** of the CMDS **500**. Each aperture of the plurality of apertures **532** extends entire through the top wall **520**, bottom wall **522**, and the pair of side walls **524** to provide communication between the central passageway **529** and the exterior environment of the dispenser **510** at each aperture of the plurality of apertures **532**. In the illustrated embodiment, the second plurality of apertures **532** allows for the fastening of the breechplate assembly **512** to the dispenser **510**, which is described in more detail below.

[0115] The breechplate assembly **512** is similar to the breechplate assembly **112** of the CMDS **100** illustrated in FIGS. **3A-9**. As illustrated in FIG. **19**, the breechplate assembly **512** includes a front plate **550**. The front plate **550** is similar to the front plate **150** of the breechplate assembly **112**, except as detailed below. The front plate **550** has a base wall **552**. The front plate **550** also includes a lateral wall **554** that is disposed about the perimeter of the base wall **552**. The lateral wall **554** extends laterally away from the base wall **552** towards the rear end **522B** of the breechplate assembly **512**. The front plate **550** also includes an upper wall (not illustrated) that is disposed about the perimeter of the lateral wall **544** and extends laterally away from the lateral wall **544** along the vertical axis “Z”. The upper wall of the front plate **550** is disposed opposite to the base wall **552**. The base wall **552**, the lateral wall **554**, and the upper wall collectively define a central opening (not illustrated) that provides access to a central space (not illustrated). In this illustrated embodiment, however, the lateral wall **554** defines a first plurality of openings **557** that extends entirely through the lateral wall **554** from exterior environment of the lateral wall **554** to the central space. The first plurality of openings **557** is coaxial with the second plurality of apertures **532** on the dispenser **510** when the breechplate assembly **512** is secured to the dispenser **510** via a first set of fasteners **534**. Furthermore, the upper wall defines a second plurality of openings (not illustrated) that extends entirely through the upper wall from the exterior environment of the upper wall to the central space.

[0116] The breechplate **512** includes a plurality of firing pins **558** substantially similar to the plurality of firing pins **158** of the breechplate **112** in CMDS **100**. The plurality of firing pins **558** are embedded in the front plate **550** of the breechplate via a plurality of holes **558A**.

[0117] Referring to FIG. **19**, the front plate **550** also includes a lip **560** that extends from the lateral wall **554** and away from the central opening and the central space along the vertical axis “Z” of the CMDS **500**. The lip **560** is parallel to the base wall **552** and is orthogonal to the lateral wall **554**. During assembly of the breechplate assembly **512** into the dispenser **510**, the lip **560** contacts the rear end of the dispenser **510** along the top wall **520**, the bottom wall **522**, and the pair of side walls **524**. The lip **560** provides a limit on how far the breechplate assembly **512** is able to be housed inside of the central passageway **529**.

[0118] The front plate **550** also includes a set of extensions **562**. The set of extensions **562** extends

laterally from the front surface **560A** of the front plate **550** and away from the front plate **550**. The set of extensions **562** are disposed proximate to the first side **500C** of the CMDS **500**.

[0119] Referring to FIG. **19**, the breechplate assembly **512** includes a circuit card **566**. The circuit card **566** is similar to the circuit cards **166**, **266** in CMDS **100**, **200**. As such, the circuit card **566** electrically connects to each firing pin of a plurality of firing pins **558** via a firing pin connector (not illustrated) substantially similar to how the circuit cards **166**, **266** electrically connects to each firing pin of the plurality of firing pins **158**, **256** in CMDS **100**, **200**. The clearance between the circuit card **566** and the plurality firing pins **556** is substantially similar to clearance “C” between the circuit card **166** and the plurality of firing pins **158**, **256** in CMDS **100**, **200**. The circuit card **566** in CMDS **500**, however, utilizes the electrical circuitry described in the circuit card **266** of CMDS **200**. In addition, the circuit card **566** includes a socket connectors (not illustrated) that allows for communication and power between the breechplate assembly **512** and the sequencer.

[0120] Still referring to FIG. **19**, the breechplate assembly **512** also includes a rear plate **572**. The rear plate **572** is similar to the rear plate **172** of the breechplate assembly **112** of CMDS **100**, except as detailed below. The rear plate **572** defines a front surface **572A** that faces the front end **500A** of the CMDS **500** and a rear surface **572B** that faces the rear end **500B** of the CMDS **500**. The rear plate **572** defines a set of holes **573** that extends entirely through the rear plate **572**. The plurality of holes **573** are sized and configured to receive a set of fasteners **577** to fasten the front plate **550**, via the plurality of openings **557** on the front plate **550**, to the rear plate **572**. Upon fastening the front plate **550** to the rear plate **572**, the circuit card **566** is disposed between the front plate **550** and the rear plate **572** inside of the central space. The rear plate **572** also includes sockets **574** that are configured to electrically connect the socket connectors to the circuit card **566** to allow the breechplate assembly **512** to communicate with the sequencer. The sockets **574** provided on the rear plate **572** are electrically connected to a wiring harness **575**. A portion of the wiring harness **575** is fastened to the rear surface **572A** of the rear plate **572**. In addition, the wiring harness **575** is configured to electrically connect with the legacy wiring harness (e.g., A Kit wiring harness) provided on the aircraft **1** such that the sequencer may communicate with and provide power to the breechplate assembly **512**.

[0121] Furthermore, the breechplate assembly **512** includes a set of push buttons **578** that are disposed on the exterior surface **552A** of the base wall **552** on the front plate **550**. Each push button of the set of push buttons **578** is disposed proximate to the lateral wall **554** on the base wall **552**. Each push button of the set of push buttons **578** is also electrically connected to the circuit card **566**. Such connection allows the breechplate assembly **512** to send information and/or data to the sequencer based on the interaction received by the set of push buttons **578**. Such interactions are described in more detail below.

[0122] Referring to FIG. **19**, the magazine **514** is substantially similar to the magazine **114** in CMDS **100**. The magazine **514** in CMDS **500**, however, operably engages the breechplate assembly **512** once the breechplate assembly **512** operably engages the dispenser **510**, which is explained in further detail above. The magazine **514** includes a top wall **580** that is disposed near the top end **500E** of the CMDS **500**, a bottom wall **582** that opposes the top wall **580** and is disposed near the bottom end **500F** of the CMDS **500**, a pair of side walls **584** positioned parallel to one another and disposed between the top and bottom walls **580**, **582**, a rear wall **586** that is disposed at the rear end **500B** of the CMDS **500**, and a front wall **588** that is disposed directly opposite to the rear wall **586** at the front end **500A** the CMDS **500**. The magazine **514** also includes a plurality of dividing walls **590** operably engaging each of the top wall **580**, bottom wall **582**, and lateral walls **584** and collectively defines a first plurality of passageways **592** that extends from the front wall **588** to the rear wall **586**. The magazine **514** also defines a front set of apertures **592A** disposed at the front end **500A** of the CMDS **500** and a rear set of apertures **592B** disposed at the rear end **514B** of the magazine **514**. Each passageway in the first plurality of passageways **592** has a front aperture from the front set of apertures **592A** and a rear aperture from the rear set of

aperture **592B** to receive and house an expendable from the plurality of expendables **516**.

[0123] Referring to FIG. **20**, the magazine **514** defines a second plurality of passageways **594** that extends through the magazine **514** from the front wall **588** to the rear end **586**. In the illustrated embodiment, the second plurality of passageways **594** are disposed parallel to the first plurality of passageways **592**. In addition, the second plurality of passageways **594** are positioned between the first plurality of passageways **592** proximate to the center of the front wall **588** of the magazine **514**.

[0124] Still referring to FIG. **20**, the magazine **514** also defines a pair of cavities **595** that extends laterally from the rear wall **586** towards the front wall **588**. The pair of cavities **595** are sized and configured to receive the pair of extensions **562** from the breechplate assembly **512** once CMDS **500** is assembled. The interaction between the pair of cavities **595** and the pair of extensions **562** provides additional support between the breechplate assembly **512** and the magazine **514** when CMDS **500** is assembled.

[0125] In the illustrated embodiment, the magazine **514** is without a muzzle plate operably engaged to the front end of the magazine **514**. However, in one exemplary embodiment, a muzzle plate may operably engage the front end of the magazine **514** similar to the muzzle plate **396** operably engaging the front end of the magazine **314** in CMDS **300**. In addition, the exemplary muzzle plate would be even with the mold line of the sidewall **3** to provide aerodynamic advantages for the aircraft **1**. Even though the breechplate assembly **512** defines a substantially similar width as the breechplate assembly **112** in CMDS **100**, the breechplate assembly **512** allows for the magazine **514** to be completely disposed inside of the dispenser **510**.

[0126] Referring to FIGS. **19-20**, the magazine **514** also includes a retaining plate **598**. The retaining plate **598** has a front surface **598A** that faces towards the front end **500A** of the CMDS **500** and a rear surface **598B** that faces towards the rear end **500B** of the CMDS **500**. The retaining plate **598** also defines a set of slots **598C** that extend entirely through the retaining plate **598** from the front surface **598A** to the rear surface **598B**. The retaining plate **598** is considered advantageous at least because the retaining plate **598** maintains the plurality of expendables **516** inside of the first plurality of passageways **592** while the magazine **514** is loaded into the dispenser **510**. In addition, the set of slots **598C** provide access to the impulse cartridges provided in the plurality of expendables **516**. The front surface **598A** of the retaining plate **598** also operably engages the rear wall **586** of the magazine **514** by securing the retaining plate **598** to the magazine **514**. While the retaining plate **598** is secured to the magazine **514**, a muzzle plate may operably engage to a magazine in any suitable arrangement. Examples of operably engaging a muzzle plate to a magazine include attaching, affixing, adhering, connecting, fastening, fixing, gluing, joining, linking, mounting, riveting, screwing, welding, and other suitable examples of operably engaging a muzzle plate to a magazine.

[0127] Furthermore, the retaining plate **598** includes a set of encoding studs **598D**. Each stud of the plurality of encoding studs **598D** extends laterally from the rear surface **598B** of the retaining pin **598** to operably engage the set of push buttons **578** embedded on front wall **550** of the breechplate assembly **512**. The interaction between the set of encoding studs **598D** and the set of push buttons **578** is communicated to the sequencer to provide magazine identification of the type of magazine being installed into the CMDS **500**. As such, the retaining plate **598** will provide a plurality of encoding studs **598D** that matches the specific size and configuration of the magazine being loaded into the CMDS **500** so that the sequencer may send suitable data for dispensing the plurality of expendables **516** during military operation. The inclusion of the set of encoding studs **598D** on the retaining plate **598** and the set of push buttons **578** on the breechplate assembly **512** is considered advantageous at least because this inclusion eliminates the need for the loader of magazine **514** to set the position switches in a CMDS or manually changing the encoder upon loading the magazine **514** into the dispenser **510**.

[0128] FIGS. **21-23** illustrates another CMDS **600** that is similar to the CMDS **300** illustrated in

FIGS. 11-15 except as detailed below. The CMDS 600 includes a dispenser 610, a breechplate assembly 612, a magazine 614, a plurality of expendables 616, and a sequencer 618. As illustrated in FIG. 21, the CMDS 600 includes a front end 600A, a rear end 600B that opposes the front end 600A, a first side 600C, a second side 600D that opposes the first side 600C, a top end 600E, and a bottom end 600F that opposes the top end 600E. The front end 600A of the CMDS 600 faces outwardly towards the bottom end 2F of the main body 2 when the CMDS 600 is provided in the chamber 5 of the aircraft 1.

[0129] In the illustrated embodiment, the dispenser 610 is a legacy D-59 Dispenser in a legacy AN/ALE-47 CMDS, which is similar to dispensers 110, 310, in CMDS 100, 300.

[0130] In addition, the breechplate assembly 612 is similar to breechplate assembly 312, except as detailed below. The breechplate defines a front plate 650, a circuit card 666, and a rear wall 672 similar to the front plate 350, circuit card 366, and rear wall 372 in breechplate assembly 312. However, the breechplate assembly 612 defines a main slot 673. The main slot 673 extends entirely through the breechplate assembly 612 such that each of the front plate 650, circuit card 666, and rear plate 672 collectively define a slot in which each slots is coaxial with each other. The breechplate assembly 612 also includes a second socket 674 that is disposed on a front surface 650A of the front plate 650. The second socket 674 is electrically connected to the circuit card 666 such that breechplate assembly 612 is able to communicate with and receive power from the sequencer 618.

[0131] As illustrated in FIG. 21, the magazine 614 includes a top wall 680 that is disposed near the top end 600E of the CMDS 600, a bottom wall 681 that opposes the top wall 680 and is disposed near the bottom end 600F of the CMDS 600, a left wall 682 that is disposed between the top and bottom walls 680, 681 and at the first side 600C of the CMDS 600, a right wall 683 that is disposed between the top and bottom walls 680, 681 and at the second side 600D of the CMDS 600, a rear wall 684 that is disposed at the rear end 600B of the CMDS 600, and a front wall 685 that is disposed directly opposite to the rear wall 684 at the front end 600A of the CMDS 600. The top wall 680, bottom wall 681, left wall 682, right wall 683, rear wall 684, and the front wall 685 collectively define a plurality of passageways 686 that extends from the front wall 685 to the rear wall 684. Each passageway of the plurality of passageways is sized and configured to house an expendable of the plurality of expendables 616. The magazine 614 also defines a front set of apertures 686A and a rear set of apertures (not illustrated). Each passageway in the plurality of passageways 686 has a front aperture from the front set of apertures 686A and a rear aperture from the rear set of aperture to receive and house an expendable from the plurality of expendables 616.

[0132] Still referring to FIG. 21, receptacle 688 is formed in the right wall 683 of the magazine 614 that extends laterally into the right wall 683 from the second side 614D of the magazine 614 and towards the first side 614C of the magazine 614. The receptacle 688 has a first upper wall 688A that is proximate to the top wall 680 of the magazine 614. The receptacle 688 also has a first lateral wall 688B that extends downwardly away from the first upper wall 688A and is orthogonal to the first upper wall 688A. The receptacle 688 also has a second upper wall 688C that extends laterally away from the first lateral wall 688B and is orthogonal to the first lateral wall 688B. The receptacle 688 also has a second lateral wall 688D that extends downwardly away from the second upper wall 688C and is orthogonal to the second upper wall 688C. The receptacle 688 also has a base wall 688E extends laterally away from the second lateral wall 688D and is orthogonal to the second lateral wall 688D. In addition, magazine 614 defines a set of cavities 689 where each cavity of the set of cavities 689 extends laterally into the right wall 683 towards the first side 600C of the CMDS 600. As illustrated in FIG. 15, the set of cavities 689 defines first and second cavities 689A, 689B that are disposed proximate to the upper wall 688A of the receptacle 688. In addition, the set of cavities 689 also defines third and fourth cavities 689C, 689D that are disposed proximate to the base wall 688B of the receptacle 689. The use of receptacle 688 and the set of cavities 689 is provided in more detail below.

[0133] The magazine **614** also includes a muzzle plate **687**. The muzzle plate **687** defines a plurality of apertures **687A** that is coaxial with the plurality of passageways **686** when the muzzle plate **687** and the magazine **614** are assembled. The muzzle plate **687** operably engages the front wall **685** of the magazine **614** similar to the muzzle plate **196** operably engaging the front wall **188** of the magazine **114** in CMDS **100**. In addition, a retaining plate (not illustrated) may operably engage the rear wall **684** of the magazine similar to the retaining plate **598** operably engaging the rear wall **586** of the magazine **514** in CMDS **500**.

[0134] The magazine **614** may have any suitable size and configuration for the plurality of passageways **686**. In one exemplary embodiment, each passageway of a plurality of passageways may have the same size and configuration in a magazine (illustrated in FIGS. **21** and **22A**). In another exemplary embodiment, a magazine may have different pluralities of passageways such that the magazine (e.g., magazine **614'**) may have a first plurality of passageways (e.g., first plurality of passageways **686'**), a second plurality of passageways (e.g., second plurality of passageways **686''**), and a third plurality of passageways (e.g., third plurality of passageways **686'''**) (illustrated in FIG. **22B**). In this exemplary embodiment, the pluralities of passageways are different sizes to carry pluralities of expendables that are different sizes. The pluralities of passageways may be sized and configured to carry certain expendables with the dimensions of 1×1×8.1 inches, 1×2×8.1 inches, 2×2.5×8.1 inches, and other expendables for a suitable situation.

[0135] Referring to FIG. **21**, the sequencer **618** in CMDS **600** has been repositioned such that the sequencer **618** operably engages the dispenser **610** and the breechplate assembly **612**. The sequencer **618** defines a front wall **690**, a rear wall **691** that opposes front wall **690**, a first top wall **692** that is proximate to the top end **600E**, a first vertical wall **693** that is disposed between the first top wall **692** and the bottom end **600F** of the CMDS, a second top wall **694** that is disposed between first vertical wall **693** and the bottom end **600F** of CMDS **600**, a second vertical wall **695** that is disposed between the second top wall **694** and the bottom end **600F** of the CMDS **600**, a bottom wall **696** disposed between the second vertical wall **695** and the bottom end **600F** of the CMDS **600**, and a third vertical wall **697** that is disposed opposite to the first and second vertical walls **693**, **695**. In the illustrated embodiment, the sequencer **618** is sized and configured to be received by the receptacle **688**. Once the sequencer **618** operably engages the receptacle **688**, the first upper wall **688A** contacts the first top wall **692** and the first lateral wall **688B** contacts the first vertical wall **693**. In addition, the second upper wall **688C** contacts the second top wall **694**, the second lateral wall **688D** contacts the second vertical wall **695**, and the base wall **688E** contacts the bottom wall **696**.

[0136] The sequencer **618** also defines a set of extensions **698**. The set of extensions **698** has first and second extensions **698A**, **698B** that extend upwardly to the top end **600E** of CMDS **600** from the first top wall **692**. The first and second extensions **698A**, **698B** are sized and configured to be received by the first and second cavities **689A**, **689B** such that the first and second extensions **698A**, **698B** operably engage the magazine **614** inside of the first and second cavities **689A**, **689B**. In addition, the set of extensions **698** has third and fourth extensions **698C**, **698D** that extend downwardly to the bottom end **600F** of the CMDS **600** from the bottom wall **696**. The third and fourth extensions **698C**, **698D** are sized and configured to be received by the third and fourth cavities **689C**, **689D** such that the third and fourth extensions **698C**, **698D** operably engage the magazine **614** inside of the third and fourth cavities **689C**, **689D**. In the illustrated embodiment, the sequencer **618** is fastened to the magazine **614** via a set of fasteners (not illustrated) fastening the set of extensions **698** to the magazine **614** inside of the set of cavities **689**. While the sequencer **618** is fastened to the magazine **614** via a set of fasteners fastening the set of extensions **698** to the magazine **614** inside of the set of cavities **689**, a sequencer may operably engage a magazine in any suitable arrangement. Examples of operably engaging a sequencer to a magazine include attaching, affixing, adhering, connecting, fastening, fixing, gluing, joining, linking, mounting, riveting, securing, screwing, welding, and other suitable examples of operably engaging a sequencer to a

magazine.

[0137] The sequencer **618** also includes a first socket connector **699A** that is sized and configured to be passed through the main slot **673** of the breechplate assembly **612**. Such configuration between the sequencer **618** and the breechplate assembly **612** allows the first socket connector **699A** to be electrically connected to a first socket **636** on the dispenser **610**. The electrical connection between the sequencer **618** and the dispenser **610** allows the CMDS **600** to receive power from the aircraft **1** and to communicate with associated electrical components provided on the aircraft **1** (e.g., programmer **14**). In addition, the sequencer **618** includes a second socket connector **699B** that connects to the second socket **674** such that the sequencer **618** provides power to the breechplate assembly **612** and communicates with the breechplate assembly **612**.

[0138] The configuration of repositioning the sequencer **618** on to the magazine **614** is considered advantageous at least because the configuration removes lengthy cabling between the sequencer **618** and the dispenser **610**. The removal of lengthy cabling may eliminate or greatly reduce the potential events of stray voltages due to the electromagnetic sources between the sequencer **618** and the dispenser **610**. In addition, the remove of length cabling may eliminate or greatly reduce the potential events of stray voltages due to cable chafing between the sequencer **618** and the dispenser **610**.

[0139] Due to the relocation of the sequencer **618** in the illustrated embodiment, the legacy wiring harness used in the aircraft **1** (i.e., A-Kit wiring harness) that electrically connects the sequencer **618** to the dispenser **610** is modified such that the CMDS **600** includes a modified wiring harness **619**. As illustrated in FIG. **23**, the wiring harness **619** is electrically connected to first and second sequencers **618A**, **618B** via first and second sequencers connector **619A**, **619B**. In addition, the wiring harness **619** is electrically connected to first and second dispensers **610A**, **610B** via first and second dispenser connectors **619C**, **619D**.

[0140] Referring to FIG. **23**, the wiring harness **619** includes a plurality of wires that electrically connect from the first and second sequencers **618A**, **618B** to the first and second dispensers **610A**, **610B**. In the illustrated embodiment, the wiring harness **619** includes a first wire W.sub.1 that is electrically connected from the first sequencer connector **619A** to the first dispenser **610A** that provides logic power to the first dispenser **610A**. In addition, a first jumper wire J.sub.1 is electrically connected to the first wire W.sub.1 in which the jumper wire J.sub.1 is electrically connected to the second dispenser **610B** to provide logic power to the second dispenser **610B**. Such electrical connection between the first wire W.sub.1 and the jumper wire J.sub.1 provides logic power to first and second dispensers **610A**, **610B**. Moreover, the wiring harness **619** includes second and third wires W.sub.2, W.sub.3 that are electrically connected from the first sequencer connector **619A** to the first dispenser **610A** to provide power to the impulse cartridges in the plurality of expendables **616**. In order to provide power to the impulse cartridges at the second dispenser **610B**, second and third jumper wires J.sub.2, J.sub.3 are electrically connected to the second and third wires W.sub.2, W.sub.3. Such electrical connection between the second and third wires W.sub.2, W.sub.3 and the second and third jumper wires J.sub.2, J.sub.3 provides logic power to first and second dispensers **610A**, **610B**.

[0141] Still referring to FIG. **23**, the wiring harness **619** includes fourth and fifth wires W.sub.4, W.sub.5 that are electrically connected from the second sequencer connector **619B** to the first dispenser connector **610A**. Each of the fourth and fifth wires W.sub.4, W.sub.5 is a first data link, similar to the first data link **15**, which allows communication between the sequencers and the dispensers in the CMDS **600**. In legacy wiring harnesses, the fourth and fifth wires W.sub.4, W.sub.5 were twisted, shield pairs to a first data link, such as the first data link **15**, which limited the communication between the sequencers and dispensers in legacy CMDS.

[0142] Moreover, the wiring harness **619** reassigns magazine identification communication lines to sequencer identification communication lines for each sequencer present on a legacy aircraft, such as aircraft **1**. The wiring harness **619** sets each sequencer address through the use of utilizing legacy

jumper wires, rather than switches, on each sequencer housing. In addition, the wiring harness **619** uses four dedicated sequencer identification communication lines, reuses first and second legacy magazine identification communication wires, and reuses first and second dispenser firing lines for third and fourth magazine identification communication lines. Such magazine relocation wires and dispensing firing lines are provided in a sixth wire W.sub.6, a seventh wire W.sub.7, an eighth wire W.sub.8, a ninth wire W.sub.9, a tenth wire W.sub.10, an eleventh wire W.sub.11, a twelfth wire W.sub.12, and a thirteenth wire W.sub.13.

[0143] Furthermore, the wiring harness **619** maintains the legacy bypass cascade wiring design from the legacy sequencer installation. In the illustrated embodiment, the bypass wiring design includes a fourteenth wire W.sub.14 (bypass flare line), a fifteenth wire W.sub.15 (bypass first other countermeasure line), a sixteenth wire W.sub.16 (bypass second other countermeasure line), and a seventeenth wire W.sub.17 (bypass enable line) that electrically connects between the second sequencer connector **619B** to the first dispenser connector **619C**. In addition, the bypass wiring design includes an eighteenth wire W.sub.18 (bypass chaff line) that electrically connects to the first sequencer connectors **619A** to the first dispenser connector **619C**. The eighteenth wire W.sub.18 and a nineteenth wire W.sub.19 (bypass Jettison line) also electrically connect the first dispenser connector **619C** to the second dispenser connector **619D**. The nineteenth wire W.sub.19 also connects the second sequencer connector **61B** to both the first dispenser connector **619C** and the second dispenser connector **619D**. In addition, a twentieth wire W.sub.20 (cascade chaff line) and a twenty-first wire W.sub.21 (cascade first other countermeasure line) electrically connect the second dispenser connector **619D** to the second sequencer connector **619B**. Moreover, a twenty-second wire W.sub.22 (cascade flare line) and a twenty-third wire W.sub.23 (cascade second other countermeasure line) electrically connect the second dispenser connector **619D** to the first sequencer connector **619A**. Furthermore, a twenty-fourth wire W.sub.24 (cascade/bypass chaff line), a twenty-fifth wire W.sub.25 (cascade/bypass flare wire), a twenty-sixth wire W.sub.26 (cascade/bypass first other countermeasure line), and a twenty-seventh wire W.sub.27 (cascade/bypass second other countermeasure line) electrically connect from the first dispenser connector **619C** to the second dispenser connector **619D**.

[0144] The installation of the wiring harness **619** cascades the bypass dispensing lines from a first sequencer and a first dispenser, such as the first sequencer **618A** and first dispenser **610A**, to a second sequencer and a second dispenser, such as the second sequencer **618B** and second dispenser **610B**. Here, the bypass wiring design functions as a reversionary mode of operation for an ALE-47 system. As such, the bypass wiring design allows an operator of military platform, such as a pilot, to bypass a programmer, such as programmer **14**, for manually dispensing countermeasure (e.g., flares and chaff) if the programmer has failed or is non-operational during military operation. The manual switches and/or signals of the bypass wiring design are routed directly to the sequencer **618** via the fourteenth wire W.sub.14, the fifteenth wire W.sub.15, the sixteenth wire W.sub.16, and the seventeenth wire W.sub.17, for manually dispensing a chaff, a flare, a first other countermeasure, and/or a second outer countermeasure during military operation. Furthermore, the first and second sequencers **618A**, **618B** cascade the bypass lines between each other to utilize the legacy wiring harnesses for routing/cascading signals between each other for dispensing countermeasures if one sequencer does not have the allotted inventory in its associated dispenser magazine.

[0145] FIG. **24** illustrates another CMDS **700** that is similar to the CMDS **200** illustrated in FIG. **10** and CMDS **400** illustrated in FIG. **17**, except as detailed below. CMDS **700** includes a dispenser **710**, a breechplate assembly **712**, a magazine (not illustrated), a plurality of expendables (not illustrated), and a sequencer **718**. CMDS **700** incorporates the circuitry of the breechplate assembly **212** in the CMDS **200** and the circuitry of the breechplate assembly **412** of the CMDS **400** into the breechplate assembly **712**. The CMDS **700** retains the legacy hardware of the sequencer **718**, the legacy wiring harnesses provided in a legacy aircraft, such as aircraft **1**, legacy dispenser **710**, and legacy logic and microprocessor provided in the breechplate assembly **712**.

[0146] In CMDS 700, the sequencer 718 has a first fire source 718A, a second fire source 718B, a third fire source 718C, and a fourth fire source 718D. Each of the first, second, third, and fourth fire sources 718A, 718B, 718C, 718D is electrically connected to a multiplexer 718F in which each of the first, second, third, and fourth fire sources 718A, 718B, 718C, 718D sends communication to the multiplexer 718F during military operation of the CMDS 700. In addition, an input device 718E is electrically connected to the multiplexer 718F. The input device 718E includes the polling operation source, the interface system (i.e., Smart Stores Communication Interface (SSCI)), and the magazine bank select operation. The input device may send communication to and receive communication from the multiplexer 718F during military operation of the CMDS 700.

[0147] The multiplexer 718F is electrically connected to a legacy wiring harness 719 that is included in the legacy aircraft 1 (i.e., Group A wiring harness in an ALE-47 CMDS). The multiplexer 718F includes a first set of firing lines 720A, second set of firing lines 720B, a third set of firing lines 720C, and fourth set of firing lines 720D, and a fifth set of firing lines 720E that are electrically connected to the wiring harness 719. The fifth set of firing lines 720E is being used to select and enable banks of firing pins and passageways in the CMDS 700, which is described in more detail below. The first, second, third, fourth, and fifth sets of firing lines 720A, 720B, 720C, 720D, 720E are then electrically connected to the legacy dispenser 710 through the wiring harness 719 via a connection 726. Moreover, the first, second, third, fourth, and fifth sets of firing lines 720A, 720B, 720C, 720D, 720E are then electrically connected to the breechplate assembly 712. As such, the sequencer 718, the dispenser 710, and the breechplate assembly 712 are able to communicate to one another via the first, second, third, fourth, and fifth sets of firing lines 720A, 720B, 720C, 720D, 720E.

[0148] In the breechplate assembly 712, the breechplate includes a sixth set of firing lines 727 that corresponds to the first set of firing lines 720 for selecting and enabling “low” and “high” side firing pins in a first bank of firing pins 712.sub.B1. The sixth set of firing lines 727 also corresponds to and communicates with the input device 718E to allow for polling of the components that are electrically connected to each of the “low” and “high” side firing pins in the first bank of firing pins 712.sub.B1, communication to the interface system, and allow for magazine bank selection.

[0149] The breechplate assembly 712 also includes a latch circuit 712A that electrically connects a seventh set of firing lines 728, an eighth set of firing lines 729, a ninth set of firing lines 730, and a tenth set of firing lines 731 from the dispenser 710 to the breechplate assembly 712. The latch circuit 712A may collect and store data from the breechplate assembly 712 that may be communicated to the associated electrical components and logic devices found in the CMDS 700. For example, the latch circuit 712A may store the electrical states of the electrical components embedded inside of the breechplate assembly 712. The latch circuit 712A is powered via the second data link 725. In addition, the sixth set of firing lines 727 bypasses the latch circuit 712A.

[0150] Each of the seventh, eighth, ninth, and tenth sets of firing lines 728, 729, 730, 731 is electrically connected to a set of “low” side firing pins and a set of “high” side firing pins in first, second, third, and fourth banks of firing pins 712.sub.B1, 712.sub.B2, 712.sub.B3, 712.sub.B4. The seventh set of firing lines 728 is electrically connected to a “low” side of firing pins 728A and a “high” side of firing pins 728B in the first bank of firing pins 712.sub.B1. The eighth set of firing lines 729 is electrically connected to a “low” side of firing pins 729A and a “high” side of firing pins 729B in the second bank of firing pins 712.sub.B2. The ninth set of firing lines 730 is electrically connected to a “low” side of firing pins 730A and a “high” side of firing pins 730B in the third bank of firing pins 712.sub.B3. The tenth set of firing lines 731 is electrically connected to a “low” side of firing pins 731A and a “high” side of firing pins 731B in the fourth bank of firing pins 712.sub.B4. In the illustrated embodiment, each of the sixth, seventh, eighth, ninth, and tenth sets of firing lines 727, 728, 729, 730, 731 includes six “low” side firing pins and six “high” side firing pins to fire a total of forty-eight expendables from the CMDS 700.

[0151] The firing of either the “low” side firing pins or the “high” side firing pins in the first, second, third, and fourth banks of firing pins **712.sub.B1**, **71282**, **712.sub.B3**, **712.sub.B4** is communicated to the sequencer **718** due to the breechplate assembly **712** and the sequencer **718** being electrically connected through the dispenser **710** (via connections **734**, **735**, **736**) and the wiring harness **719**.

[0152] In addition, a clock **732** and a bit storage device **733** are electrically connected to the latch circuit **712A**. The breechplate assembly **712** also includes a bit loading device **712C** that is electrically connected to the first, second, third, and fourth banks of firing pins **712.sub.B1**, **712.sub.B2**, **712.sub.B3**, **712.sub.B4**. The bit loading device **712C** is also electrically connected to the latch circuit **712A**. The bit loading device **712C** receives and stores data and information regarding the states and/or statuses of the “low” side firing pins and the “high” side firing pins in each of the first, second, third, and fourth banks of firing pins **712.sub.B1**, **71282**, **712.sub.B3**, **712.sub.B4**. Such data and information is sent to the latch circuit **712A**.

[0153] The electrical configuration of CMDS **700** is considered advantageous at least because CMDS **700** utilizes both a bank select configuration and a switched passageway configuration for firing either “low” side firing pins or “high” side firing pins during military operation. In other words, CMDS **700** is utilizing both the electrical circuitry in CMDS **200** and **400**. The CMDS **700** also utilizes legacy components provided in the legacy aircraft to minimize the need of updating or reconfiguring a CMDS in a legacy aircraft. Moreover, the impulse cartridges are isolated from the fire lines to prevent against inadvertent dispensing, reducing stray voltage, and electrical shorting of firing lines when the magazine is not installed.

[0154] FIG. **25** illustrates a method **800** for dispensing expendables from a CMDS. An initial step **802** comprises providing a breechplate that is operably coupled to a dispenser disposed on a platform. Another step **804** comprises providing a magazine for insertion into the dispenser, the magazine operably engaging the breechplate and housing a plurality of expendables. Another step **806** comprises initiating a countermeasure dispensing system. Another step **808** comprises determining the number of expendables from the plurality of expendables housed inside of the magazine. Another step **810** comprises selecting at least one firing pin from a set of firing pins, wherein the at least one firing pin is one of a pair of firing pins electrically connected to a firing line in the set of firing lines. Another step **812** comprises sending a first signal, by the sequencer, to the at least one firing pin in the pair of firing lines. Another step **814** comprises dispensing a first expendable from the magazine by the at least one firing pin in the pair of firing pins.

[0155] The method **800** of dispensing expendables from a CMDS may include optional steps. An optional step may comprise selecting a second firing pin from the set of firing pins, wherein the second firing pin is one of the pair of firing pins electrically connected to the firing line in the set of firing lines; this optional step may be performed after step **814**. Another optional step may comprise sending a second signal, by the sequencer, to the second firing pin in the pair of firing lines; and dispensing a second expendable from the magazine by the second firing pin in the pair of firing pins; this optional step may be performed after step **814**. Another optional step may comprise providing a first voltage to the first signal that is less than the Zener voltage of a Zener diode that is in series with the sequencer. Another optional step may comprise providing a second voltage to the second signal that is greater than the Zener voltage of the Zener diode that is in series with the sequencer. Another optional step may comprise sending the first signal, via the sequencer, to a field programmable gate array (FPGA); and outputting the first signal, via the FPGA, to the at least one firing pin in the pair of firing pins by enabling a first logic switch to a closed position and a second logic switch to an open position. Another optional step may comprise of sending the second signal, via the sequencer, to the FPGA; and outputting the second signal, via the FPGA, to the second firing pin in the pair of firing pins by enabling the first logic switch to an open position and the second logic switch to a closed position. Another optional step may comprise of enabling the power of the data link, via the sequencer, for polling the set of firing pins prior to dispensing the plurality

of expendables; selecting the at least one firing pin in the pair of firing pins via the sequencer; and selecting a second firing pin in the pair of firing pins via the sequencer.

[0156] The magazines of each CMDS described and illustrated herein may have any suitable passageway configuration based on the size and/or type of expendable used in a CMDS. In one exemplary embodiment, a magazine may have a passageway configuration for expendables with the dimensions of 1×1×8.1 inches where the magazine may have a total of forty-eight passageways that meet the 1×1×8.1-inch expendable dimension. In this exemplary embodiment, the magazine may also hold between forty-eight passageways up to sixty passageways that meet the 1×1×8.1-inch expendable dimension. In another exemplary embodiment, a magazine may have a passageway configuration for expendables with the dimensions of 1×1×8.1 inches and 1×2×8.1 inches where the magazine may have four passageways that meet the 1×1×8.1-inch expendable dimension and twenty-two passageways that meet the 1×2×8.1-inch expendable dimension. In another exemplary embodiment, a magazine may have a passageway configuration for expendables with the dimensions of 1×1×8.1 inches and 2×2.5×8.1 inches where the magazine may have twenty-eight passageways that meet the 1×1×8.1-inch expendable dimension and four passageways that meet the 2×2.5×8.1-inch expendable dimension. In another exemplary embodiment, a magazine may have a passageway configuration for expendables with the dimensions of 1×1×8.1 inches, 1×2×8.1 inches, and 2×2.5×8.1 inches where the magazine may have ten passageways that meet the 1×1×8.1-inch expendable dimension, nine passageways that meet the 1×2×8.1-inch expendable dimension, and four passageways that meet the 2×2.5×8.1-inch expendable dimension. In another exemplary embodiment, a magazine may have a passageway configuration for expendables with the dimensions of 1×1×8.1 inches, 1×2×8.1 inches, and 2×2.5×8.1 inches where the magazine may have three passageways that meet the 1×1×8.1-inch expendable dimension, twelve passageways that meet the 1×2×8.1-inch expendable dimension, and four passageways that meet the 2×2.5×8.1-inch expendable dimension.

[0157] A military platform, such as the aircraft **1**, may provide any suitable number of CMDSs that are described and illustrated herein on the military platform. Examples of suitable numbers of CMDS provided on a military platform include one, at least one, two, a plurality, three, four, five, six, and any other suitable number of CMDSs that may be provided on a military platform. In addition, any CMDS described and illustrated herein may be provided on a military platform. In one exemplary embodiment, a military platform may include a single type of CMDS on the military platform, such as CMDS **100**, for use during military operation. In another exemplary embodiment, a military platform may include different types of CMDSs on the military platform, such as CMDS **100** and CMDS **500**, for use during military operation.

[0158] Various inventive concepts may be embodied as one or more methods, of which an example has been provided. The acts performed as part of the method may be ordered in any suitable way. Accordingly, embodiments may be constructed in which acts are performed in an order different than illustrated, which may include performing some acts simultaneously, even though shown as sequential acts in illustrative embodiments.

[0159] While various inventive embodiments have been described and illustrated herein, those of ordinary skill in the art will readily envision a variety of other means and/or structures for performing the function and/or obtaining the results and/or one or more of the advantages described herein, and each of such variations and/or modifications is deemed to be within the scope of the inventive embodiments described herein. More generally, those skilled in the art will readily appreciate that all parameters, dimensions, materials, and configurations described herein are meant to be exemplary and that the actual parameters, dimensions, materials, and/or configurations will depend upon the specific application or applications for which the inventive teachings is/are used. Those skilled in the art will recognize, or be able to ascertain using no more than routine experimentation, many equivalents to the specific inventive embodiments described herein. It is, therefore, to be understood that the foregoing embodiments are presented by way of example only

and that, within the scope of the appended claims and equivalents thereto, inventive embodiments may be practiced otherwise than as specifically described and claimed. Inventive embodiments of the present disclosure are directed to each individual feature, system, article, material, kit, and/or method described herein. In addition, any combination of two or more such features, systems, articles, materials, kits, and/or methods, if such features, systems, articles, materials, kits, and/or methods are not mutually inconsistent, is included within the inventive scope of the present disclosure.

[0160] The above-described embodiments can be implemented in any of numerous ways. For example, embodiments of technology disclosed herein may be implemented using hardware, software, or a combination thereof. When implemented in software, the software code or instructions can be executed on any suitable processor or collection of processors, whether provided in a single computer or distributed among multiple computers. Furthermore, the instructions or software code can be stored in at least one non-transitory computer readable storage medium.

[0161] Also, a computer or smartphone utilized to execute the software code or instructions via its processors may have one or more input and output devices. These devices can be used, among other things, to present a user interface. Examples of output devices that can be used to provide a user interface include printers or display screens for visual presentation of output and speakers or other sound generating devices for audible presentation of output. Examples of input devices that can be used for a user interface include keyboards, and pointing devices, such as mice, touch pads, and digitizing tablets. As another example, a computer may receive input information through speech recognition or in other audible format.

[0162] Such computers or smartphones may be interconnected by one or more networks in any suitable form, including a local area network or a wide area network, such as an enterprise network, and intelligent network (IN) or the Internet. Such networks may be based on any suitable technology and may operate according to any suitable protocol and may include wireless networks, wired networks or fiber optic networks.

[0163] The various methods or processes outlined herein may be coded as software/instructions that is executable on one or more processors that employ any one of a variety of operating systems or platforms. Additionally, such software may be written using any of a number of suitable programming languages and/or programming or scripting tools, and also may be compiled as executable machine language code or intermediate code that is executed on a framework or virtual machine.

[0164] In this respect, various inventive concepts may be embodied as a computer readable storage medium (or multiple computer readable storage media) (e.g., a computer memory, one or more floppy discs, compact discs, optical discs, magnetic tapes, flash memories, USB flash drives, SD cards, circuit configurations in Field Programmable Gate Arrays or other semiconductor devices, or other non-transitory medium or tangible computer storage medium) encoded with one or more programs that, when executed on one or more computers or other processors, perform methods that implement the various embodiments of the disclosure discussed above. The computer readable medium or media can be transportable, such that the program or programs stored thereon can be loaded onto one or more different computers or other processors to implement various aspects of the present disclosure as discussed above.

[0165] The terms “program” or “software” or “instructions” are used herein in a generic sense to refer to any type of computer code or set of computer-executable instructions that can be employed to program a computer or other processor to implement various aspects of embodiments as discussed above. Additionally, it should be appreciated that according to one aspect, one or more computer programs that when executed perform methods of the present disclosure need not reside on a single computer or processor, but may be distributed in a modular fashion amongst a number of different computers or processors to implement various aspects of the present disclosure.

[0166] Computer-executable instructions may be in many forms, such as program modules, executed by one or more computers or other devices. Generally, program modules include routines, programs, objects, components, data structures, etc. that perform particular tasks or implement particular abstract data types. Typically the functionality of the program modules may be combined or distributed as desired in various embodiments.

[0167] Also, data structures may be stored in computer-readable media in any suitable form. For simplicity of illustration, data structures may be shown to have fields that are related through location in the data structure. Such relationships may likewise be achieved by assigning storage for the fields with locations in a computer-readable medium that convey relationship between the fields. However, any suitable mechanism may be used to establish a relationship between information in fields of a data structure, including through the use of pointers, tags or other mechanisms that establish relationship between data elements.

[0168] All definitions, as defined and used herein, should be understood to control over dictionary definitions, definitions in documents incorporated by reference, and/or ordinary meanings of the defined terms.

[0169] “Logic”, as used herein, includes but is not limited to hardware, firmware, software and/or combinations of each to perform a function(s) or an action(s), and/or to cause a function or action from another logic, method, and/or system. For example, based on a desired application or needs, logic may include a software controlled microprocessor, discrete logic like a processor (e.g., microprocessor), an application specific integrated circuit (ASIC), a programmed logic device, a memory device containing instructions, an electric device having a memory, or the like. Logic may include one or more gates, combinations of gates, or other circuit components. Logic may also be fully embodied as software. Where multiple logics are described, it may be possible to incorporate the multiple logics into one physical logic. Similarly, where a single logic is described, it may be possible to distribute that single logic between multiple physical logics.

[0170] Furthermore, the logic(s) presented herein for accomplishing various methods of this system may be directed towards improvements in existing computer-centric or internet-centric technology that may not have previous analog versions. The logic(s) may provide specific functionality directly related to structure that addresses and resolves some problems identified herein. The logic(s) may also provide significantly more advantages to solve these problems by providing an exemplary inventive concept as specific logic structure and concordant functionality of the method and system. Furthermore, the logic(s) may also provide specific computer implemented rules that improve on existing technological processes. The logic(s) provided herein extends beyond merely gathering data, analyzing the information, and displaying the results. Further, portions or all of the present disclosure may rely on underlying equations that are derived from the specific arrangement of the equipment or components as recited herein. Thus, portions of the present disclosure as it relates to the specific arrangement of the components are not directed to abstract ideas.

Furthermore, the present disclosure and the appended claims present teachings that involve more than performance of well-understood, routine, and conventional activities previously known to the industry. In some of the method or process of the present disclosure, which may incorporate some aspects of natural phenomenon, the process or method steps are additional features that are new and useful.

[0171] The articles “a” and “an,” as used herein in the specification and in the claims, unless clearly indicated to the contrary, should be understood to mean “at least one.” The phrase “and/or,” as used herein in the specification and in the claims (if at all), should be understood to mean “either or both” of the elements so conjoined, i.e., elements that are conjunctively present in some cases and disjunctively present in other cases. Multiple elements listed with “and/or” should be construed in the same fashion, i.e., “one or more” of the elements so conjoined. Other elements may optionally be present other than the elements specifically identified by the “and/or” clause, whether related or unrelated to those elements specifically identified. Thus, as a non-limiting example, a

reference to “A and/or B”, when used in conjunction with open-ended language such as “comprising” can refer, in one embodiment, to A only (optionally including elements other than B); in another embodiment, to B only (optionally including elements other than A); in yet another embodiment, to both A and B (optionally including other elements); etc. As used herein in the specification and in the claims, “or” should be understood to have the same meaning as “and/or” as defined above. For example, when separating items in a list, “or” or “and/or” shall be interpreted as being inclusive, i.e., the inclusion of at least one, but also including more than one, of a number or list of elements, and, optionally, additional unlisted items. Only terms clearly indicated to the contrary, such as “only one of” or “exactly one of,” or, when used in the claims, “consisting of,” will refer to the inclusion of exactly one element of a number or list of elements. In general, the term “or” as used herein shall only be interpreted as indicating exclusive alternatives (i.e. “one or the other but not both”) when preceded by terms of exclusivity, such as “either,” “one of,” “only one of,” or “exactly one of.” “Consisting essentially of,” when used in the claims, shall have its ordinary meaning as used in the field of patent law.

[0172] As used herein in the specification and in the claims, the phrase “at least one,” in reference to a list of one or more elements, should be understood to mean at least one element selected from any one or more of the elements in the list of elements, but not necessarily including at least one of each and every element specifically listed within the list of elements and not excluding any combinations of elements in the list of elements. This definition also allows that elements may optionally be present other than the elements specifically identified within the list of elements to which the phrase “at least one” refers, whether related or unrelated to those elements specifically identified. Thus, as a non-limiting example, “at least one of A and B” (or, equivalently, “at least one of A or B,” or, equivalently “at least one of A and/or B”) can refer, in one embodiment, to at least one, optionally including more than one, A, with no B present (and optionally including elements other than B); in another embodiment, to at least one, optionally including more than one, B, with no A present (and optionally including elements other than A); in yet another embodiment, to at least one, optionally including more than one, A, and at least one, optionally including more than one, B (and optionally including other elements); etc.

[0173] When a feature or element is herein referred to as being “on” another feature or element, it can be directly on the other feature or element or intervening features and/or elements may also be present. In contrast, when a feature or element is referred to as being “directly on” another feature or element, there are no intervening features or elements present. It will also be understood that, when a feature or element is referred to as being “connected”, “attached” or “coupled” to another feature or element, it can be directly connected, attached or coupled to the other feature or element or intervening features or elements may be present. In contrast, when a feature or element is referred to as being “directly connected”, “directly attached” or “directly coupled” to another feature or element, there are no intervening features or elements present. Although described or shown with respect to one embodiment, the features and elements so described or shown can apply to other embodiments. It will also be appreciated by those of skill in the art that references to a structure or feature that is disposed “adjacent” another feature may have portions that overlap or underlie the adjacent feature.

[0174] Spatially relative terms, such as “under”, “below”, “lower”, “over”, “upper”, “above”, “behind”, “in front of”, and the like, may be used herein for ease of description to describe one element or feature's relationship to another element(s) or feature(s) as illustrated in the figures. It will be understood that the spatially relative terms are intended to encompass different orientations of the device in use or operation in addition to the orientation depicted in the figures. For example, if a device in the figures is inverted, elements described as “under” or “beneath” other elements or features would then be oriented “over” the other elements or features. Thus, the exemplary term “under” can encompass both an orientation of over and under. The device may be otherwise oriented (rotated 90 degrees or at other orientations) and the spatially relative descriptors used

herein interpreted accordingly. Similarly, the terms “upwardly”, “downwardly”, “vertical”, “horizontal”, “lateral”, “transverse”, “longitudinal”, and the like are used herein for the purpose of explanation only unless specifically indicated otherwise.

[0175] Although the terms “first” and “second” may be used herein to describe various features/elements, these features/elements should not be limited by these terms, unless the context indicates otherwise. These terms may be used to distinguish one feature/element from another feature/element. Thus, a first feature/element discussed herein could be termed a second feature/element, and similarly, a second feature/element discussed herein could be termed a first feature/element without departing from the teachings of the present invention.

[0176] An embodiment is an implementation or example of the present disclosure. Reference in the specification to “an embodiment,” “one embodiment,” “some embodiments,” “one particular embodiment,” “an exemplary embodiment,” or “other embodiments,” or the like, means that a particular feature, structure, or characteristic described in connection with the embodiments is included in at least some embodiments, but not necessarily all embodiments, of the invention. The various appearances “an embodiment,” “one embodiment,” “some embodiments,” “one particular embodiment,” “an exemplary embodiment,” or “other embodiments,” or the like, are not necessarily all referring to the same embodiments.

[0177] If this specification states a component, feature, structure, or characteristic “may”, “might”, or “could” be included, that particular component, feature, structure, or characteristic is not required to be included. If the specification or claim refers to “a” or “an” element, that does not mean there is only one of the element. If the specification or claims refer to “an additional” element, that does not preclude there being more than one of the additional element.

[0178] As used herein in the specification and claims, including as used in the examples and unless otherwise expressly specified, all numbers may be read as if prefaced by the word “about” or “approximately,” even if the term does not expressly appear. The phrase “about” or “approximately” may be used when describing magnitude and/or position to indicate that the value and/or position described is within a reasonable expected range of values and/or positions. For example, a numeric value may have a value that is $\pm 0.1\%$ of the stated value (or range of values), $\pm 1\%$ of the stated value (or range of values), $\pm 2\%$ of the stated value (or range of values), $\pm 5\%$ of the stated value (or range of values), $\pm 10\%$ of the stated value (or range of values), etc. Any numerical range recited herein is intended to include all sub-ranges subsumed therein.

[0179] Additionally, the method of performing the present disclosure may occur in a sequence different than those described herein. Accordingly, no sequence of the method should be read as a limitation unless explicitly stated. It is recognizable that performing some of the steps of the method in a different order could achieve a similar result.

[0180] In the claims, as well as in the specification above, all transitional phrases such as “comprising,” “including,” “carrying,” “having,” “containing,” “involving,” “holding,” “composed of,” and the like are to be understood to be open-ended, i.e., to mean including but not limited to. Only the transitional phrases “consisting of” and “consisting essentially of” shall be closed or semi-closed transitional phrases, respectively, as set forth in the United States Patent Office Manual of Patent Examining Procedures.

[0181] In the foregoing description, certain terms have been used for brevity, clearness, and understanding. No unnecessary limitations are to be implied therefrom beyond the requirement of the prior art because such terms are used for descriptive purposes and are intended to be broadly construed.

[0182] Moreover, the description and illustration of various embodiments of the disclosure are examples and the disclosure is not limited to the exact details shown or described.

Claims

- 1.** A method comprising: providing a breechplate operably coupled to a countermeasures dispenser, the breechplate comprising a first set of firing pins and a second set of firing pins both electrically coupled to a sequencer, wherein the first set of firing pins is electrically coupled to corresponding first set firing lines, and the second set of firing pins are paired firing pins, wherein the paired firing pins are electrically coupled to corresponding second set firing lines; providing a magazine for insertion into the dispenser, the magazine operably engaging the breechplate and capable of housing a plurality of expendables; initiating, during flight, a countermeasure dispensing system, wherein the countermeasure dispensing system performs the following: determining which of the expendables from the plurality of expendables housed inside the magazine to be dispensed; selecting at least one selected firing pin from at least one of the first and second set of firing pins to allow for the determined expendables to be dispensed; sending a signal from the sequencer to at least one of the second set of firing pins via the second set firing lines; controlling, by a single circuit card, one or more switches that electrically couple at least one of the first and second set of firing lines to the first and second set of firing pins; and dispensing at least one of the determined expendables by at least one firing pin in the pair of firing pins.
- 2.** The method of claim 1, further comprising: sending an additional signal from the sequencer to the second firing pin in the pair of firing pins; and dispensing an additional determined expendable.
- 3.** The method of claim 1, further comprising: providing the signal from the sequencer having a first voltage that is less than a Zener voltage of a Zener diode that is in series with the sequencer.
- 4.** The method of claim 1, further comprising: providing the signal from the sequencer having a second voltage that is greater than a Zener voltage of a Zener diode that is in series with the sequencer.
- 5.** The method of claim 1, wherein the single circuit card is a field programmable gate array (FPGA) and further comprising: outputting the signal from the sequencer to the at least one firing pin in the pair of firing pins by enabling a first logic switch to a closed position.
- 6.** The method of claim 5, further comprising: sending an additional signal from the sequencer to the FPGA; and outputting the additional signal to the second firing pin in the pair of firing pins by enabling a second logic switch to a closed position.
- 7.** The method of claim 1, further comprising: polling the set of firing pins by the sequencer for readiness; and selecting the at least one firing pin in the pair of firing pins following the polling.
- 8.** The method of claim 1 further comprising processing information of an incoming threat.
- 9.** The method of claim 8 wherein the initiating of the countermeasure dispensing system is done following processing of the incoming threat.
- 10.** The method of claim 1 wherein the initiating the countermeasure dispensing system is done manually.
- 11.** The method of claim 1 further comprising providing feedback from the selected firing pin.
- 12.** The method of claim 1 wherein the first and second set of firing pins have a first end and a second end and further comprising defining a shock isolation clearance between the second end of the firing pins and the circuit card.
- 13.** A computer program product including one or more non-transitory machine-readable mediums encoded with instructions that when executed by one or more processors cause a process to be carried out for countermeasures, the process comprising: initiating, during flight, a countermeasure dispensing system; determining a number of expendables from a plurality of expendables housed inside a magazine to be dispensed; selecting at least one selected firing pin from at least one of a first set of firing pins and a second set of firing pins, the first and second set of firing pins being electrically coupled to a sequencer, with the first set of firing pins being electrically coupled to corresponding first set firing lines, and wherein the second set of firing pins are paired firing pins, with the paired firing pins being electrically coupled to corresponding second set firing lines; controlling, by a single circuit card, one or more switches that electrically couple at least one of the

first and second set of firing lines to the first and second set of firing pins; sending a first signal from the sequencer to at least the second set of firing pins; and dispensing at least one of the expendables by the at least one selected firing pin in the pair of firing pins.

14. The computer program product of claim 13, further comprising: sending a second signal from the sequencer to the second firing pin in the pair of firing lines; and dispensing a second expendable by the second firing pin in the pair of firing pins.

15. The computer program product of claim 13, further comprising: providing the signal from the sequencer having a first voltage that is less than a Zener voltage of a Zener diode that is in series with the sequencer.

16. The computer program product of claim 13, further comprising: providing the signal from the sequencer having a first voltage that is greater than a Zener voltage of a Zener diode that is in series with the sequencer.

17. The computer program product of claim 13, further comprising: sending the first signal from the sequencer to a field programmable gate array (FPGA); and outputting the first signal, via the FPGA, to the at least one firing pin in the pair of firing pins by enabling a first logic switch to a closed position and a second logic switch to an open position.

18. The computer program product of claim 17, further comprising: sending the second signal from the sequencer to the FPGA; and outputting the second signal, via the FPGA, to the second firing pin in the pair of firing pins by enabling the first logic switch to an open position and the second logic switch to a closed position.

19. The computer program product of claim 13, further comprising: polling the set of firing pins by the sequencer for readiness; and selecting the at least one firing pin in the pair of firing pins following the polling.

20. The computer program product of claim 13, wherein the first and second set of firing pins have a first end and a second end and further comprising defining a shock isolation clearance between the second end of the firing pins and the single circuit card.
